Research and Development

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39225561.

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra)

Characters:
Entrapta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Imp (She-Ra), Emily (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Character Study, Eventual Smut, Shameless Smut, Hordak-centric (She-Ra), Porn, Porn With Plot, Porn with Feelings, Emotional Constipation, Clueless Hordak, Less Clueless Entrapta, Voyeurism, Virginity, Awkwardness, Gratuitous Smut, Sex, Oral Sex, Power Dynamics, no beta - we die like immortals, which means no one is dying, cuz dying is unpleasant

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Part 1 of Research & Development

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by csishewolf

Summary

Hordak has a problem. His body is malfunctioning again, but it only happens when he is around Entrapta. If he is going to successfully open a portal and prove his worth to Horde Prime, he needs to fix this flaw. Immediately.

Notes

Disclaimer: Not mine. This is for fun, peeps. Not profit.

A/N: I'm late to the party again, but my muse finds these two utterly adorable, and demanded I get them smutting. This is easier said than done, especially since I'd prefer to keep them as in-character as possible. I'm also a wee bit out of practice. And I don't have a beta. And I might legitimately burn in hell for this. These are children's cartoon characters.

But hey, it's all good. Hope you folks enjoy!

Timeline: Story starts around Season 2, Episode 3: Signals.

Chapter 1

Hordak has a problem. His body is malfunctioning. Again. Such problems are de facto for him; he is a defective nightmare. Each day is a constant battle to keep himself from falling apart. But now there is a new irregularity. A troubling one.

It involves the organ his body uses to expel liquid waste. Hordak never paid it much attention. It served its purpose and that was that. But now, there are tingles. Sometimes it throbs. It also expands, squeezing itself against his undergarment.

This only occurs when he is in the company of Entrapta.

He paces about his quarters, the dim evening light casting his agitated shadow across his resting platform. His body needs sleep, much to his dismay, but his mind is far too active to permit such an activity tonight.

These malfunctions do not happen every time he and Entrapta work together. They are, of course, focused on their common goal – opening the portal. That is key. That is his salvation, his way to prove his worth to Horde Prime. He will conquer this pathetic planet single-handedly in the name of his Brother. This will ensure his return to his rightful place at Prime's side. That is his purpose. That is where he belongs.

He pauses, relaxing fingers he unknowingly clenched into fists. He will not achieve his goal if his body fails him before the portal is operational. He must maintain his focus. But this… anomaly… it is an unknown. Hordak does not like unknowns.

He resumes his trek, booted footsteps clomping against the smooth dark floor. There have been other physical sensations around Entrapta. Yet the warmth that blooms in his chest is not unfamiliar; it represents his fondness and respect for her. He has felt this warmth before, with others who serve under him. It is what the Etherians call a "happy feeling". These feelings are

increasing in number, but this too is logical. Entrapta pleases him greatly – their progress has been significant.

However, there are also some disturbingly irrational behaviors. There are times she looks at him and his thoughts become clouded. Occasionally when she speaks to him, he is unable to form words in reply. And there was one instance when her gloved fingertip brushed across the top of his hand. A tingling shiver had raced up his arm and down his spine.

In fact, yes… soon after that the issue with his organ started.

Thinking about her touch causes another twinge. It isn't entirely unpleasant, but it is abnormal.

Nothing in his clone training referenced that organ as anything other than a waste disposal mechanism. But Hordak is no fool – this flaw is biological in nature. If he is to return to Horde Prime and prove his worth, he needs to resolve it. Immediately.

^*^*^*^*^

When the amber Etherian moon dawns across the Fright Zone, Hordak heads to the library that once belonged to Scorpia's people. His anatomy is not all that dissimilar from the Etherians, perhaps a book or datacard on the subject will fill the gap in his knowledge. He passes a medical bay, noting the disarray of paperwork and pamphlets strewn across the intake counter. He dislikes clutter, and a brief scowl at the two nurses stationed there triggers them into reparative action.

Satisfied, he continues to the library, only to stop cold within the curved metallic doorway. The sheer volume of books and information displayed within the large expanse will require him to do something highly unpleasant. Request assistance.

There are Horde soldiers scattered among the dark metal tables within the library, insects resting before their next flight. And like insects are wont to do, they cluster together and buzz quietly amongst each other. Hordak stiffens his spine and walks into the

cavernous space. Immediately all noises cease, and many curious, questioning eyes turn toward him.

This is unacceptable. He lifts a claw and points to the doorway. “Is this how you serve me? Return to your posts.” Slightly louder, “Now.”

All before him scramble and bumble their way past. Satisfied, Hordak approaches the librarian - an older Etherian female, once a resident of Erelandia but conscripted by Shadow Weaver over a decade ago to provide this service to his people. She is, as expected, cowering behind the main desk.

Fear is a useful tool, but it has its drawbacks. He is glad Entrapta does not fear him like this. It would hamper their progress.

“Cease your nonsense. I require your assistance.”

The Erelandian squeaks and stammers. “How… how might I help you, Lord Hordak?”

He pauses, taking the time to phrase his request properly.

“I am seeking information on the physiology of Etherians. Primarily anatomy.” In a flash of inspiration he adds, “I am researching ways to biomechanically enhance our troops for improved strength. And speed. And intelligence.”

He stops himself from rambling, but grins all the same. That isn’t a bad idea.

The look of horror on the librarian’s face is textbook. These Etherians. So backwater. She appears stuck that way, so he growls, “Provide me with this information.”

“Oh! Yes, yes my Lord. Please wait here. There are a couple books that I believe will suit your needs.”

She scurries away and returns exactly one minute after Hordak’s patience wears thin. There is an expression of triumph in her grin

as she clutches three hardcover scientific manuals to her chest. He yanks them from her grasp with a snarl. “These had better be worth the time I wasted waiting for them.”

A gulp and a whimper. “Oh, my Lord, I’m certain they will be.”

“We shall see.”

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They do prove extremely useful. Hordak spends an hour skimming each, and quickly learns that the organ in question is used for organic reproduction. The concept is somewhat mind-boggling, and if he’s honest, rather unhygienic. Males inseminate the female via the release of a fluid containing one half of the DNA required to create a new life form. The female has eggs within her that contain the other half. When the two join, new life is created.

To Hordak, this seems barbaric and primitive. Where is the assurance that each half is clean and viable? Where are the controls to keep the new life form stabilized? The haphazardness of it all grates against his psyche. Clone creation is strictly controlled to prevent any failures. He is a rarity as a defect. This… this abomination leaves everything entirely to chance. The risk is high. How is this even permitted in a civilized society? It’s abhorrent.

He has zero desire to create a new life form with Entrapta. So why does his body behave as if he does? The books do not explain the strange sensations, but a diagram clearly articulates what the swelling is for. The male’s member must become engorged to penetrate the female. And at some point in time, fluid is released. Details on this are not provided.

He glances down, disturbed that his body can do what is described in these manuals.

A small chime on a terminal indicates it is officially time to start his day. He pushes thoughts of swollen anatomy from his mind. The portal is the priority. The portal, and nothing else.

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It is early evening when Hordak returns to his quarters. There were no twinges or swellings today. Just inputting data into computers, running calculations, tweaking code. The majority of the day was spent in silence – well, on his part. Entrapta often speaks to herself, or to her ever-present bot. It does not distract him; her chatter has become akin to the hum of machinery. Mere background noise.

He retrieves the three manuals and heads to the library. Perhaps now that he has become educated, his mind will keep his body in check. Upon arrival, as expected, there are far fewer soldiers clustered around the tables. Most are elsewhere, stuffing their faces. It is the evening mealtime.

The librarian notices him immediately, and rushes toward him, eager to serve his whim. "Thank you for these," he states. "The information was indeed useful." Hordak prides himself on acknowledging his people when they do as he commands.

Her voice trembles. "Oh! Oh! I am glad to hear that. Thank you, my Lord."

She doesn't retreat until Hordak's eyes meet hers. No words are said, but she recognizes her error, bows and returns to her duties.

He decides to visit the disorganized medical bay prior to returning to his quarters for the evening. He is pleased to see the two nurses have corrected their error from before. He says nothing but scans the counter of the intake window with a critical eye. A stack of booklets grabs his attention, and he plucks one free with his claws.

'Horde Regulations Regarding Sexual Activity, including Available Health Services'

The word 'Sexual' is what caught his eye. 'Sex' was a word used within the manuals. "What is this?"

The taller one blushes as the smaller one replies, “Pretty much what it says on the front cover. They’re your regulations, yes?”

Hordak blinks and the nurses peer at him curiously. “Of course they are,” he snaps, even though he has no idea about any of this.

“He might be questioning why they are out on the counter, Yvelle,” the taller nurse murmurs.

“Oh! Well, Lord Hordak, Sir… we want to make sure that any new recruits, or anyone of age really, has access to that information. The more prominent the better, I always say! I sincerely doubt you want a bunch of infants born here in the Fright Zone.”

“I do not.”

“Well then,” the short one nods.

Time to reassert his authority. “Your area was disheveled this morning. Be sure it does not happen again.” He glares at the two women, who synchronously backpedal away from him.

“Yes, my Lord,” they parrot in unison.

He turns and returns to his quarters, the booklet clasped within his grasp.

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The booklet provides Hordak with a wealth of information. Not everything is clear, but enough is articulated to expand his education significantly. Shadow Weaver must have instituted this program without his approval. He is irritated by her arrogance, but also grateful for her wisdom.

Etherians do not mate just to procreate. They do it for fun. It is apparently quite pleasurable for them. In fact, they do it so frequently they require medicines or other implements to prevent the creation of a new life form.

Hordak is forced to acknowledge there is far more to this concept of sexuality than just procreation. The booklet mentions multiple ways to ensure 'safe sex' and it articulates many options for accomplishing this. It highlights the appropriate 'protection' for a male/female coupling, a female/female coupling, and a male/male coupling. It specifically states that all are acceptable within the Horde, but activities of this nature must occur off-hours, and must not disrupt others. Anyone who forces sexual activity onto another without their consent will be banished to Beast Island immediately.

Hordak's imagination short-circuits as he digests this new information. The booklet is not illustrated, unlike the hardback manuals, so he is unable to picture how the same-sex couplings would work.

This leads him to wonder if Entrapta has partaken in any couplings. If she has, was it with another male? Or does she prefer females?

The thought of her with anyone irritates him. He can feel his anger rising, and something within his chest is rumbling possessively. He rationalizes that his outrage is justified, as such dalliances would distract her from their work. But he knows there is minimal logic to that argument. Her evenings are her own. Even though she spends many with him working on the portal, that is by her choice, and not his demand.

The booklet also implies the twinges and occasional throbbing are related to the pleasure sensations associated with this primitive reproduction. Hordak wouldn't call them pleasurable, but they do not pain him.

He feels wise, and relieved. His body is reacting to Entrapta. She is female. He is male. They spend a great deal of time together. That is all this is. Perhaps it is a phase, and will pass in time.

^*^*^*^*^

It does not pass in time. If anything, it becomes more of a distraction than ever. He now sees Entrapta as more than a partner. He sees her as female. He spends an inappropriate amount of time studying her – he struggles to keep his eyes from her. She is soft, curvy and rather cute to look at. It's like Imp in a way, but then, it's nothing like Imp at all.

He notices her eyelashes. The way her clothing curves around her body. Her scent, which meant nothing to him before, now has meaning. That scent means she is close to him, and his treacherous body is reacting to that. Her voice has become pleasing, particularly when she says his name a certain way. It is a serious tone, less hyper. Low and throaty.

The tingles are omnipresent, and the throbbing and swelling alternate the entire time he is near her.

He tries to avoid her, but she is far too intelligent to let such behavior slide. She confronts him about it after two days.

"Is everything… are you okay?" she asks quietly while adjusting a chip on a circuit board with a micro-driver.

"Yes. Yes, everything is fine. I am fine."

"Mmm… response contains five more words than normal." She turns and studies him. "Ears tilted slightly back, eyes wide." She nods to herself. "Discomfort. Not fine." There is a pause before she says, "Did I do something? Sometimes that happens. I say or do a wrong thing and I don't know it."

"You have done nothing wrong, Entrapta." He wants to take her in his arms and comfort her. He wants to press his body against hers. The urge to do so is quite strong.

What is happening to him? He needs to leave. Now.

But he cannot. His feet will not move. Instead, he stares at her, fighting to keep his arms at his sides, to keep his body still. Warmth is spreading from his chest to his cheeks, and also

straight down to his abdomen. His undergarment is now uncomfortable. Again.

"Well, okay. Good. But you're acting strangely. Perhaps you weren't aware."

He's quite aware, thank you.

She smiles, "Well, now you are! I like it when people tell me that I'm doing strange things. Otherwise, how would I know?"

Hordak has had more than enough of this. "I may be overtired. I will rest."

Her focus has returned to her circuit board. "Okay. See you."

Hordak hurries to his quarters, slamming the door shut. He curses himself in his own native language, as well as two others. He cannot deny this any longer.

His body wants to mate with Entrapta.

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

A/N: *points at rating*
Timeline: Season 2, Episodes 6 (Light Spinner) & 7 (Reunion)

Hordak has no idea how, or even if, mating with Entrapta is possible. What is he supposed to do? His mind is blank, slamming hard into an unidentifiable wall. He leans back against his throne, banging his head in frustration.

Imp chooses that moment to flutter into the room, returning from his daily task of recording any interesting conversations or events that occurred. Hordak strokes the small creature's ears when he lands near his shoulder.

"Anything worthwhile today?" he asks softly. Imp shakes his head slowly before replaying a few sound bytes of an officers' meeting.

Hordak is pleased he kept Imp, despite the fact he represents Hordak's inability to create a viable clone of himself. Imp was his first attempt, and he contains genetic material from a bat-like creature here on Etheria. A significant mistake in terms of a clone, but a benefit as well. Imp is an excellent spy – he can see and hear things Hordak never could.

The idea streaks bright across his mind. *That* is how he can learn about the mating process. He can observe it!

Hordak glances at Imp. He doesn't want to subject his tiny companion to such base behaviors. More importantly, he doesn't want Imp to know that Hordak is considering such behaviors at all. Despite his inability to speak, Imp is created from Hordak's own DNA. He is intelligent.

Yet the concept of spying to learn what he needs is brilliant. He can leverage the existing camera network within the Fright Zone.

In fact, he can add more – as many as he likes. This is his domain, after all.

He ponders the logistics of this task. Most of his people have small but private quarters. Only the lowest ranking military personnel share bunks. The crowded conditions are meant to encourage movement in rank or specialization. Cameras will need to be added to all these locations, as well as any other secluded areas. In addition to the cameras, one of the terminals in Hordak's quarters will need to be configured to have unlimited access to the network and any repositories housing the footage.

This all must be implemented in a way not to upset the Etherians. They will not look kindly on having cameras in their private spaces. However, per the booklet, couplings happen primarily in those locations. Hordak needs visibility to them.

Hordak types up what he needs in a local file. While doing so, he comes up with the justification. Theft. The cameras will be installed in response to a rampant stream of theft that has started within the Fright Zone.

He grins toothily at Imp. "I have a new mission for you. One I think you will enjoy."

^*^*^*^*^

The implementation of his plan takes two weeks. The first week is Imp, having the time of his life stealing things from people's quarters. He shows his treasures gleefully to Hordak before stashing them away in the high alcove he calls home.

The second week starts with Hordak calling a meeting with his highest ranking officers and staff, explaining the problem and his solution. As many in attendance were personally impacted by Imp's sticky fingers, they do not question his directive. Not even Force Captain Catra has a complaint. Hordak is unsure what Imp took of hers, but it must have been an item of importance.

Five days later, a senior security officer finally approaches him.

“Lord Hordak. The surveillance monitoring system is integrated into your terminal, as you requested.” The sandy-haired and slightly balding human lingers and Hordak raises his brow in askance. “Are you familiar with the software?” the officer asks. “Or do you require an overview?”

Hordak is certain he could figure it out on his own, but a demonstration suits his mood. “I am familiar. Show me anyway.”

“Yessir.”

Hordak makes a low noise in his throat, and the officer pales to white as he corrects himself. “Yes, Lord Hordak.”

He stifles a grin. Intimidating Etherians is such an enjoyable activity. Hordak follows the terrified human into his quarters and watches with benign interest as the officer explains the video interface.

“You can use these controls to pan and zoom on the live image. However, anyone in the room will see and hear the camera’s movement. Currently all cameras are configured to view as much of the given space as possible. I don’t recommend moving them.”

Hordak nods and the officer continues. “Each camera is designated with a floor number and location number.” He taps at the terminal and a database table appears. “The master directory is found here.”

“Who is maintaining this?”

“Two security techs are assigned to the oversight of the cameras. Part of their duty is to maintain the directory.”

Hordak doesn’t like the idea of lowly techs having video access to his people’s private quarters. This is his own personal research network, he doesn’t need any Etherians using it for their own nefarious purposes as well.

“Provide me with the names and ranks of these techs. These individuals will have access to a great deal of private information. I want them held to the highest standard of integrity.”

The older human nods knowingly. “Yes, we thought of that. Both techs are female and are senior level. They can be trusted to be discrete. The lead tech already manages the video network; it was she who personally recommended the second, due to the increased workload. I myself can personally vouch for both of them.”

“Good,” Hordak replies. “But I will need their information.”

“Of course, sir… Lord Hordak.” He gestures back to the terminal. “If I may…?”

“Continue.”

“All that I’ve shown you is related to the real-time feeds. But we also archive all footage for thirty days. That can be found… here.”

A much more sophisticated interface is displayed on the screen. Hordak is impressed with the quality of the archived data, and the tools available to manipulate it. In addition to pan, zoom and volume controls, Hordak can slow or speed up the footage, increase or decrease the lighting quality, jump to a specific point in time – anything he desires.

“This is impressive.”

The officer grins. “It’s a little side project the lead security tech, myself and a few others are working on.”

“Your skill is noted.”

“Thank you.”

“Let the others know as well. You have pleased me.”

“Yes, yes Lord Hordak.”

Hordak is eager to play around with his new toy. “You are dismissed. I expect the details of those two techs within the hour.”

The officer bows and departs quickly. Which is fortunate for him, as the minute the door closes, Hordak is flipping through the live-feed cameras, eager to see all of what he can now see. He decides to avoid the cameras of those he interacts with regularly. Entrapta’s name is at the top of that list, for obvious reasons. Catra, Scorpia, and the other Force Captains are also off limits. Just imagining their private lives… it makes him cringe.

But the others? Hundreds of anonymous Etherians are all fair game, and Hordak stays up late into the night switching through camera after camera on the live feed software. Sadly, he finds nothing that implies mating. His army is well-behaved and functions smoothly despite appearing chaotic. Many of his soldiers are weary, sleeping the instant they are in their quarters. Likewise, the closets and various alcoves where illicit trysts might occur are left empty and undisturbed.

He yawns, drained from the day’s work and the evening’s intensity. He had expected to see some activity right away, and is disappointed that his assumption did not materialize into reality. This will not be simple.

Yet Hordak isn’t one to be derailed. He will learn how to properly mate with Entrapta and purge these biological urges from his body, no matter how long it takes.

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A week passes before Hordak has an early evening to continue his research. He and Entrapta had a significant setback with the portal, a glitch in his original design that was not compatible with their, well… her newer enhancements. The anomaly caused an infinite loop, which overheated three of their four super-capacitors, caused a not-so-small explosion, and overloaded the entirety of the Fright Zone’s power grid.

Entrapta was not deterred, and is crafting new capacitor relays to prevent this from happening again. Hordak cannot say the same. The power grid was heavily damaged, and is taking far too long to repair. His mood is quite foul, his patience razor thin.

While meeting with Force Captain Catra, that patience wore to nothing. He demanded she either make use of Shadow Weaver or dispose of her via Beast Island. That witch is far too dangerous to keep lingering around in a Horde cell.

The only positive is that his constant state of ire has overridden any bodily misbehaviors.

He considers tossing the mating research aside, so terrible is his mood. So when he decides to poke around the video archives, it is with a detached randomness that is uncharacteristic of him. Which, as these things always go, is when he finds what he's looking for.

A young male and female human are together upon a resting platform. The male is atop the female, her knees bent and her legs spread wide as he thrusts into her. Hordak freezes, the image answering so many of his questions.

There is movement! He thought so. He turns up the volume and the soft grunts and cries of the couple drown his ears. This has an instantaneous effect on his already tingling organ. It swells quickly and he shifts it upward so it is not so painful against his undergarment.

The male moves faster, until he pushes himself hard against the female with a groan. The couple do not move for a few moments, but when they separate, Hordak is given full view of the Etherian male and female anatomy. The male's member is shorter, and thicker, than his own. It is also surrounded by short fur. As for the female, she is thin with small breasts and a furry patch between her thighs. They use a cloth to wipe themselves – Hordak assumes this is to remove the fluid that was referenced in the manuals.

The male starts to dress, and the female looks at him in disappointment. “Can’t you stay?” she asks.

“You know what people would say if we got caught.”

“I told you – things aren’t like that here. I don’t think they’ll care.”

“I do! I’m your commanding officer!”

There are tears in the female’s eyes when the male leaves. She removes the coverings from her resting platform and replaces them with new ones. She then moves off camera, assumedly to the washroom.

Hordak pauses the footage, then rewinds it. He watches their interlude from the beginning, entranced. The male spends a total of twenty-two minutes with the female. They start by pressing their lips together for a time before undressing. Once their clothing is removed, they put their lips on various parts of each other’s bodies. Hordak doesn’t think much of this until the female does a bizarre thing that is both repulsive and highly erotic. The female puts the male’s organ into her mouth and moves up and down its length. This goes on for exactly three minutes, making Hordak incredibly uncomfortable but unable to turn away. His own organ throbs painfully and feels very hot and tight. When she stops, the male’s member is very swollen. Hordak can relate! But the male does not put it inside the female. Instead he does something Hordak can’t quite see, but he assumes the male put his mouth on the female’s opening. She begins to vocalize, and Hordak watches, fascinated, as the female writhes and moans, until she arches her body and cries out. The male lifts his head, wipes his mouth, and then, finally, he is atop the female, thrusting away.

Hordak observes their coupling, but his mind is focused on what the male did to the female. That male brought her pleasure.

He wants to do that to Entrapta.

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Hordak skips everything the next day, stating he has private work to do. Which is true, he is 100% focused on the archives and expanding his knowledge. The predominant couplings on the video footage are male/female. He finds two male/male couplings, three female/female couplings, and one with two females and a male.

It is new and unique to see, but after a while Hordak notes they all follow a similar pattern. All begin with the lip-pressing and then move on to various stages of undress. Most remove all their clothing, but some do not. Most place their mouths on their partner's genitalia, much to the partner's delight. From there it leads to penetration. Some skip the mouth contact and just do the penetration, others only do mouth contact with no penetration.

The female/female couplings' interactions are varied. These females are the most attentive when pleasuring their partners. He sees one female pair use implements that penetrate one or both of them. But the other two do not; they use their mouths or fingers and hands instead. Hordak stares down at his own hand. His claws would most certainly harm Entrapta.

The male/male couplings teach him that males are stimulated to release via hand movements, similar to what the human female did with her mouth. The males also penetrate each other from behind. This must be the solid waste opening, which makes Hordak extremely squeamish, but for the Etherians, it obviously brings them great pleasure. The two male/male couples are by far the most comfortable with each other - before, during and after any encounters. He will not research their couplings further, but he is slightly envious of their perceived happiness.

The set of three is dominated by the male, who dictates his wishes to the females. He does not please the females, but he tells them to touch each other, which they do. There is something about his behavior, and the expressions on the females' faces, that disturbs Hordak. He researches the male - a mid-level supervisor within the mining division. The two women report to him.

It reminds him of his first couple, and how that male officer thought it was wrong to mate with an underling. This other male does not, and Hordak suspects he is abusing his position of authority. He will provide Imp with a new assignment the next time he sees him.

Throughout his research, Hordak's organ swelled and throbbed. But not nearly as much as it did when he saw that first coupling. Perhaps he has finally tamed his body into compliance. Now that he is fully educated, there is no mystery and hence, no cause for excitement.

He does scan for later footage of the first couple, purely out of curiosity. The male does not return to her quarters, but one segment shows the female rushing into her room and slamming the door. She then proceeds to bawl excessively for five whole minutes on her resting platform, clutching her pillow. Hordak scoffs. Etherians can be so dramatic.

He yawns and checks the terminal for the time. By the stars, he's been awake for almost eighteen hours. No wonder his body feels so drained. He strips off his tunic and damp undergarment and crawls into his resting platform to sleep, his mind replaying all the images he's seen.

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Hordak wakes to midday light and a sharp banging at his door. A high-pitched wail is coming from the other side. He wraps his waist in a sheet and opens the door, only to teeter back as Imp flies directly into his face. He swats at the annoying creature, but Imp is far too familiar with Hordak, and far too fast for Hordak to actually reach him.

"[Where's Hordak?]" Imp replays from a beam high above the main terminal. It's Catra's voice. "[I need to see him.]"

Another recording, this time of Force Captain Octavia. "[Lord Hordak needs to sign these forms. The mining supervisor won't

accept them without it.]”

“Fine. I will be out within the hour.” He scowls at Imp. “Feel free to share my timeline with whomever you deem fit.”

His small companion smiles toothily and flies away. Hordak’s mind is groggy, his skin clammy. He does not bathe in the same way as the Etherians, but a washing feels necessary. He steps into a small cubicle and seals the door shut. He designed this system with the help of Shadow Weaver during the early years of transforming Scorpia’s kingdom into his Fright Zone. A push of a yellow button sprays a synthetic sanitizing coating across his body. The downside is that the coating takes a few minutes to reach full effectiveness, so he is stuck standing around doing nothing while he waits.

He idly palms his organ, noting the differences between himself and the Etherians. He strokes the base cautiously, but does not feel anything. He tests his touch, moving upwards towards the tip. He rubs his thumb lightly over the delicate skin, and there is a tingling sensation. He continues, and it swells within his grasp. Fascinated, he mimics the movements he saw on the videos, and watches in both horror and amazement as his organ hardens and his foreskin retracts. There is a deep, almost instinctive, urge to continue. He’s snapped out of his stupor by the soft chime indicating that the next phase of his bath is about to begin.

He is doused with bone-achingly cold water from above, which makes him yelp and drowns all thoughts of self-experimentation from his mind. Fortunately, he is then immediately dried by blowers that flick open and blast all traces of chemicals and water from every inch of his body. His ports are semi-waterproof, but with all his other failings, he does not want to take any chances. He pushes a button to run the dry cycle again, the tepid air doing little to warm his chilled body.

No, he does not like bathing. Not one bit.

Cleaned and dried, he dons his undergarment, tunic and armor and heads towards his Sanctum. Yet the memory of what he did to himself lingers. What was he thinking? Why did he do that? He shudders. What is wrong with him?

An hour later, Imp visits him again, his wings twitching with barely contained energy. Hordak pushes his shame from his mind. This day is about to get more interesting - his little spy has uncovered something good. What he replays sends Hordak's blood to its boiling point. Shadow Weaver has escaped, and it is Force Captain Catra's fault.

"Summon her," he tells Imp.

She will be tested. He wonders how Catra will fare as he runs a claw over the activation lever for one of his first and oldest machines. It's been a while since he used it, perhaps he will get the chance today.

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

> **Timeline:** ~~Season 2, Episodes 8 & 9~~ Season 3, Episodes 1 (The Price of Power) & 2 (Huntara)
>
> **A/N:** I'm fairly certain y'all will be able to follow where this chapter aligns to canon. If you folks are anything like me, you've watched these two episodes quite a few times. Still - I welcome any and all feedback. Also, please keep in mind this is just as much a character study as a smutfic. I'm aiming to keep them as in-character as possible within the context of the story/smut.

Hordak lifts the data pad off the table, tapping on the screen. The numbers displayed validate Entrapta's assessment of Catra's leadership. They are hard to dismiss. He regrets his outburst, but Entrapta does not understand. She is Etherian, after all.

Catra lied to him. Lied! Hordak does not tolerate deception of any kind within his army. Truth is one of the strongest pillars of Horde Prime's culture. To not be transparent with Prime is to not be true to one's self. Hordak applied that same paradigm here in the Fright Zone, to demonstrate to Prime how well he respects His teachings. Catra needs to be taught a lesson.

He tosses the data pad back onto the table, returning to his terminal to focus on his other, more significant problem. His armor is randomly short circuiting. He's unsure if a port was damaged during his recent bathing, or if it is a larger issue with his body and armor. Perhaps it is punishment for what he did - when he touched himself. That would be fitting. Thoughts of mating have long left his mind, overridden by pain and the familiar, simmering rage of living with a body that continues to fail him. Having to deal with Shadow Weaver's escape and Catra's deception is just additional fuel for that fire.

The power grid's restoration is the only positive. Work on the portal has resumed, consuming all of Entrapta's attention. It has been easy to avoid her. Revealing his weaknesses to her, or anyone, is unacceptable. He is Hordak.

He scans the Sanctum, noting the scattered tubing, discarded parts, and overall clutter of a non-working portal. If Entrapta says she needs the First Ones' tech, then she must need it. Hordak grumbles under his breath, reluctant to accept what he must do. "Forgive me, Brother. This is for the greater good."

^*^*^*^*^

Days later, Hordak stares at his reflection in the terminal monitor within his Sanctum. The sentencing of Catra did not go as planned. Catra made him appear weak. Even though she is well on her way to the Crimson Waste, the unwavering devotion of his people has been shaken. He doesn't need to hear it from Imp, although recordings of dissent are coming in daily. Hordak can see it in their eyes as he passes them in the hallways.

Eyes that once held fear now hold questions. They study him, rather than defer to him. Catra has seeded doubt in their minds, and that doubt will grow like fungus unless Hordak does something to prove his strength and power.

He cannot prove it physically. Though still a secret to everyone but Imp, his body is in the worst shape it's ever been since he landed in this forsaken hole of a planet. His work on enhancing his armor has gone nowhere. His only option is the portal. He needs to get that portal open before decades of his work start to fall apart irreparably. This is now a multi-faceted race against time. A race of his own body's failings, as well as his army's growing doubts in his leadership, against Entrapta's ability to get his portal working.

She mentioned that today would be the day they run their first test. He can only hope that it will be a successful one.

^*^*^*^*^

Hordak's mind is reeling as he tests out his new armor for the … he's lost count how many times he's lifted the terminals in his quarters off the ground. There is true strength coursing through his veins. Powerful doesn't begin to describe it. Despite the disaster with the portal earlier, this day is one he will long remember. The failings of his body have been addressed. He feels fantastic.

His problems with his army are also solved. He can use this new exoskeleton to intimidate his people as needed. In fact, if the dissent grows beyond the murmur it is now, he can make examples out of a few of them. Maybe he'll do it anyway. A public display of his abilities will quell any doubts as to who leads the Horde Army.

And he owes it all to Entrapta. His thoughts regarding her are a tangled mess. What was she thinking, running towards the portal like that? If she was killed, where would he be without her? He was so incredibly angry – at their failure, at her for putting her life at risk. In that moment, everything did seem hopeless.

And then, she didn't listen to him. She never listens. She doesn't take 'No' for an answer either. It is incredibly frustrating. Now she knows everything about him and his weaknesses. That fact still isn't sitting well with him, despite her response. At a minimum, he assumed she would acknowledge his failings, or in his worst-case scenario, run from him in horror. Instead, she said his imperfections were beautiful and made him this armor.

Hordak does not have the words for how he feels about this.

But he does acknowledge he did not thank her properly. Ripples of guilt are replaying his bumbled speech in his mind. Imp nagged him with it as well after she left. Twice. Then he screeched at Hordak for quite some time before flying away.

He will speak with her. Tonight after mealtime. He will go to her and he will say proper words of gratitude. He will tell her that he too views her as a friend.

^*^*^*^*^

Hordak hovers outside of Entrapta's quarters, staring at the door. He recalls the registry listing in his mind. #4357. That is this door, right?

He takes a deep breath and exhales slowly, desperate to quell the strange sensations in his abdomen. Those are not nerves. He is not nervous. He single-handedly created the most powerful army in Etheria. He can do this, too.

He raises a fist and knocks. There is no response, so he waits a moment and knocks again, a little harder.

Nothing happens. The tension in his chest subsides. Oh well, he did try. He will tell her tomorrow when she returns to his Sanctum to start repairing the portal. It's a wreck.

He turns and takes two steps before hearing the door swish open behind him.

"Hordak?"

He whirls and she is there before him, not in her usual attire but a pale baggy sleeveless top and what the Etherians call 'shorts'. Those are purple. Her feet are covered by lilac slippers, each depicting a large-eyed overly cute creature Hordak has never seen before. The milliseconds it takes to register this are dwarfed by the main focus of his attention, the bare skin of her legs.

"Gah…" he sputters.

"What?"

"I… I have disturbed you. I will…"

"No… it's fine. I'm not doing anything." She waves for him to enter. "Want to come in?"

Hordak blinks as his feet willingly take him into Entrapta's quarters. Her room is more of a lab than a place of rest. The only item of comfort he can see is the large purple sofa near the middle of the room. Beyond it is a huge terminal where Entrapta clearly spends most of her time. Her bot is in one corner, its violet light flashing as it acknowledges his presence.

On one wall is a framed portrait of a much younger Entrapta with two robots, as well as a frame containing another wide-eyed creature. The rest of the room is a hodgepodge of shelves, boxes and tables, all coated with tools, parts, and mechanical clutter.

Entrapta's hair inspects his new armor, poking and prodding. "Is everything working ok? It's brand new, so it might have a few bugs."

He swipes at the tendrils. "I did not come here because of the armor," he spats.

"Oh," she replies, her hair retreating to hang straight behind her.

Ugh. Now he's upset her. Why is he so terrible at this? "I…"

"Do you want to sit?"

"What?"

"Well, you are a guest and the rules of hospitality say you should offer a guest a seat." Entrapta gestures toward the sofa. "And maybe not poke at them," she mutters. "So, do you want to sit?"

Fine. He'll sit.

She settles next to him and the awkward silence between them grows, until they both speak at the same time.

"Entrapta, I…"

"Hordak, do you…"

They look at each other and Entrapta scowls. Hordak's cheeks feel hot.

"I don't know why this is so difficult!" she hollers. "We talk all the time in your lab. My lab shouldn't be any different." She turns away from him. "I'm sorry. Social situations aren't really my thing. I've been studying them my entire life, even more since I started living here in the Fright Zone, but I still seem to fail terribly at them."

He places his hand on her knee. It's instinctive. "I told you, you are not a failure."

She stares at it and gasps, and he yanks it back, mortified.

"No, it's not that," she blurts. "It's your hand. It's warm. I guess I expected it to be cold. I mean, you're blue and white. Those colors are associated with cold things. Water. Ice. Snow."

Hordak doesn't know what to say to this.

"So, why are you here again?" she asks.

"I wanted to thank you properly," he replies. The words flow surprisingly easily. "I don't think you realize the significance of what you've done for me by creating this armor."

"It was fun! Might be my best work ever with First Ones' tech. Plus I didn't like seeing you like that." Her tone shifts from boisterous to serious. "You scared me."

"I scared you? Do you know how frightened I was when you ran towards the portal? You could have been killed!"

"But I wasn't!" She pauses. "Oh, that was because of you. Wait, is that why you collapsed?"

Hordak says nothing.

“It is!” Entrapta stares at him, her eyes a mix of horror and shame. “It was my fault,” she mutters.

“No,” he growls softly. “My body’s been failing for a long time.”

“But taking the brunt of an explosion didn’t help, did it?”

“It did not.”

“I’m sorry.” Her next words are almost a whisper. “I would never do anything to hurt you.”

He brushes away the strands of hair shielding her face. Again, it’s instinctive. “Look at what you’ve done for me,” he tells her. “I am strong again. That is because of you.” His hand lingers, and she cautiously touches it with her own.

“Warm,” she states. Her fingers brush gently against the skin of his hand. “Not as rough as I assumed, but not smooth either.” She presses against a claw. “Not razor sharp, but I’d bet they'd do some damage if you put your mind to it.”

Hordak swallows, hard. Her touch is slightly cool, very light, and causing twinges in an area he’d rather remain dormant.

“I have to be careful when touching things. Certain textures bother me. That’s one of the reasons I wear my gloves. But it’s not the main one. Mostly I need to protect my hands from all the sharp metal. Or getting electrocuted. Although that still happens sometimes anyway.” She stops tracing patterns on his palm and reaches for his face. “Can I… touch you?”

He must be insane, but he nods.

Her fingertips press down against his cheek. “Not as rough as the skin on your hands. Also, much warmer.”

It would be. Hordak would swear he’s burning alive.

She moves upwards to his hair. “Very thick and wiry. Not soft at all.” She tilts her head and frowns. “That’s disappointing. I thought it would be silky.”

She strokes one of his ears. “Now that’s what I expected. Smooth skin. Still much warmer than I imagined, though.”

Hordak shifts his weight, hoping Entrapta doesn’t notice what’s happening with the lower half of his body. He glances down. Nothing looks suspicious, but if she keeps this up, he’s going to have a tough time hiding that swelling.

“Do you,” she starts, but then pauses. Her voice is sultry, but hesitant as she asks, “Do you want to touch me? I mean, that’s only fair. But only if you want to.”

Two tiny voices cry out simultaneously in Hordak's mind - one roaring in triumph, the other screaming in abject terror. He ignores both, cautiously placing his palm against her cheek, and she gasps as a tremor runs through her hair.

“The warmth,” she murmurs, “it’s just so different.”

Her skin is thinner than his, so seemingly fragile. Yet he knows she is far stronger than she appears. He strokes her hair with his other hand, and her eyes close.

“It’s nice,” she sighs. “You can keep doing that. I mean, if you want to.”

He strokes her brow again, and her long hair is rising up, reaching for him. All the footage he viewed is flashing through his mind. He curses himself for not paying more attention to the lip-pressing parts.

Unsure of what to do, he touches his forehead to hers. “You are important to me,” he whispers.

“Likewise. With you, to me, I mean.” And then her lips press against his.

Hordak freezes. Entrapta misinterprets this and withdraws quickly.

“Oh. I shouldn’t have kissed you. Sorry! Sorry about that. See! I am terrible…”

“No! You are not. It’s… I am pleased you did that.” Kissing. So that’s what it’s called. He exhales heavily, deciding to be honest with her. “I am… not familiar with how to do it properly.”

Entrapta’s head tilts a significant fifty-five degrees to the left in confusion for exactly 1.2 seconds. Then she leaps from the sofa and starts pacing her room, hair waving in many directions. “Wow! I missed that. I did not put it together at all. How did I miss that?”

Now it’s Hordak’s turn to be confused, and she reads his expression well.

“This is new for you, isn’t it. You’re a clone. You’ve never been kissed, let alone anything else for that matter, have you?”

He shakes his head, staring at the scratches in her floor. Why did he ever think she would want to mate with a defect like him? He has no clue about…

“Fascinating! Oh, and utterly terrifying. Probably for you too.”

He blinks. Wait, what?

Her hair is reaching for the edge of his tunic as she studies his lap. “You are male, right?”

He whacks it away. “I am very much a male!” he snarls.

“I thought so. Just wanted to confirm.”

Her hair is still trying to lift his tunic, so he stands and walks away from her, swatting at it.

“Oh, sorry.” Her hair retreats and then forms into the familiar brace where it lifts her off the floor and supports her weight. “Sometimes it has a mind of its own.” She’s grinning at him, sitting cross-legged with her chin resting on the knuckles of her fists. It’s a wide-eyed type of grin, like she’s just been handed new First Ones’ tech.

“What?”

“You like me!” she blurts happily. Her bot beeps loudly. “Oh, and I like you too. Satisfied, Emily?” The bot chirps. Entrapta’s head tilts again. “You do like me, right?”

Hordak nods, his face flaming.

The bot makes a squelching sound. “Oh! I should clarify. When I say I like you, I mean that I’d like for us to be… how do I say this in a way you’ll understand… more physical with each other?”

Hordak’s throat is dry and now the heat has oddly spread to his chest.

She continues, “I mean, just the social experimentation value alone is reason enough. You’re an alien! The data regarding a sexual encounter… And the warmth, too! There’s just so many unknowns! And that’s without even considering the impacts of the emotional components! So what do you say? Do you want to give it a try?”

Are his ears working properly? Is she really saying she wants to mate with him?

The bot beeps again, more of a screech than a beep.

“Emily!” Entrapta commands, her tone suddenly stern. “Shutdown sequence 1-8-4-6. Activate.”

The bot powers down.

“She thinks I’m ruining it by being too scientific,” Entrapta explains. “Plus there are other reasons why she needs to take a nap for a while. So…?”

Hordak is mute. He opens his mouth, but no words come out, so he closes it again. This just might be one of the best days of his life, and here he is, botching it with his verbal constipation.

“You are familiar with sex, right?” She walks around him, hair periodically poking at his body. “Maybe not – you are a clone. But if you’re male, then somewhere in the biology of your species, there has to be a female. Well, I guess it is the biology of the species you’re cloned from. Do you know what race they are? Do you know anything about their developmental and reproductive history?”

The poking, combined with the horrific thought of Horde Prime doing something as impure as organic coupling is too much for him. “Entrapta!” he barks. “I am familiar with the mating practices here on Etheria.”

“Oh! Well, good then.” She stops her frenetic movement and frowns. “Hold on, have you actually done it with someone?”

“No.”

“Oh. Okay. But do you know how to… no.” She shakes her head. “That won’t work. Let’s try this: What do you know?”

Now Hordak’s ears are hot. “I know of the activities you speak, but have not partaken in them myself.” He scowls. “Is that the answer you are looking for?”

“Yes, actually that helps a lot.” Entrapta looks him straight in the eye and asks, “Do you ejaculate?”

Can his hair catch fire? It just might, given that his whole head is turning into an embarrassment inferno. The sad part is he doesn’t know whether he produces the mating fluid or not. He sighs heavily. Truth above all. “I don’t know.”

She steps towards him, her hair forming back into hands that again reach for his tunic. “Wanna find out?”

“No!” This is not how he imagined any of this taking place.

“Oh. Well, that’s something I’ll need to know if we’re going to do this.”

Her questioning begins to make sense. “You are concerned about creating a new life form.”

“Yes.” She nods to herself and mutters, “Not completely clueless.” Louder, she says, “I don’t even know if we’re compatible in that way, but I don’t want to take any chances.”

“Nor do I.”

“There are numerous ways to prevent conception, but if there’s no risk, there’s no point in adding them to this equation.”

Hordak understands. Memories of his last bathing come to mind, and he shakes his head to clear it.

“What?”

Must she be so observant? He is not about to explain that to her at all. She’s already ripped his masculine pride to shreds with this conversation. “I will get you an answer,” he grumbles through gritted teeth.

“Good. Wait, does that mean yes? You really want to…?”

Hordak has had enough. So he strides towards her, wraps her in his arms and presses his lips firmly to hers. He doesn’t care if he’s doing it properly, he just wants to take back a modicum of control over this situation.

Her body leans into his and her mouth presses back. Somehow, he knows what to do and they start to kiss in the way he remembers from the video footage. Her hair is wrapped around

him, and he cups her face in his hands as he moves his lips against hers. His body thrums and his chest purrs. He is enjoying this. A lot.

Her cheeks are flushed and her eyes glassy when Hordak finally breaks away. Despite his body's protests, they cannot continue. It would be unsafe.

He presses his lips to her forehead. “Good night, Entrapta.” He is out her door before barely hearing her dreamy reply of “… m’okay… bye!”

Hordak is halfway to his quarters, mind still reeling, when he realizes he actually learned something useful this evening. He now knows how to shut Entrapta up.

Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

A/N: *points at rating again*

Timeline: After S3E2 (Huntara) but before Season 3, Episode 4 (Moment of Truth)

Hordak stirs, flickers of a dream wisping away from his consciousness. It involved Entrapta, but how could it not? Yesterday was a rather significant day. And last night was surprisingly unexpected. He blinks and rises, still struggling to comprehend his new reality. Entrapta is willing... no, eager to mate with him. Hordak again ponders why, and can only assume it is due to her insatiable curiosity and scientific mind. He is something novel, unknown. She said so herself. However, she does appear to be fond of him; she did say she enjoyed being his friend. He supposes the combination of the two is enough to justify her reasoning.

His rationale is much simpler. His body must mate with her. Hordak cannot deny what is so plaintively obvious to him now. It wanted her last night, and memories of her pressed against him are causing twinges in his organ now. Those twinges remind him of the downside of his new situation. He owes Entrapta an answer. They cannot mate without it. Hordak grimaces. He knows his body will respond to his touch. It's just so… primitive. Repugnant.

He will also need Entrapta to construct a device to remove this new exoskeleton. Hordak has seen enough footage to know just how messy the couplings can be. Frequent bathings will be required. He sighs, running his claws through his hair, struggling with the juxtapositions.

Disgruntled, he heads to the terminal with the footage of the Etherians. Maybe viewing them will help with this process. He

calls up the first video he viewed, having saved it locally, and is rewinding it when there is a loud scrape and a bang from the rafters above him.

“What… Is… That?” Entrapta is dangling upside down a short distance above his head, coated in dust, her eyes fixated on the monitor.

Hordak immediately clicks the video software closed. “Entrapta! These are my private quarters! Get out!” She is infuriating!

Her body lowers until she is facing him, still upside down. “I couldn’t sleep last night, so I decided to check on you. I was curious if you were going to do anything … well… interesting, and I wanted to see. It took a lot to get here too. Did you know your room is surrounded by thick, high walls? The only way in or out is through that tiny ventilation shaft. Also, you kind of snore.” She scans his quarters while righting herself before plopping down next to him, her boots clomping against his floor. She then brushes off her clothing, while her hair performs a strange undulation that magically dispels most of the dust. “I didn’t think you had a big enough nasal cavity for snoring, but I guess you do. This is much nicer than my lab. And that bed is huge!” She turns to him. “We should definitely do it in here. But what,” her hair points at the now-dark monitor, “was that?”

Hordak owes her no explanation. “It is not your concern.”

“That sure looked like video from a surveillance camera. And those people... they were... was that here in the Fright Zone?” She pauses. "It was, wasn’t it! I remember when the cameras were installed in everyone’s rooms. That was… sixty-seven days ago. I hotwired mine right after the tech left – it alternates between an empty room and a forty second loop of me sleeping that runs for six hours.” Her hair taps at the terminal keyboard, attempting to restart the software. “So, do you have access to all the cameras? How many days of footage does the system store? It can’t be too many, that much raw data would be huge! This is amazing!" She cackles with glee. "I have to see it. Can I see it?”

“No.”

Her tapping is, of course, successful. She hacks everything she touches. The video archive software reloads onto the screen, displaying a still frame of that first couple within the throes of mating. “Wait a sec… is this how you learned about sex? By watching people?”

Hordak says nothing, but he wonders if every encounter with Entrapta will now result in his cheeks burning. Maybe he should kiss her, so she’ll stop talking.

She turns to face him, eyes bright. “That’s what you did, isn’t it? That’s why this is here.”

Hordak is not answering that. Not now, not ever.

Her hair pats his shoulder. “You shouldn’t be ashamed. It’s brilliant. I wish I had thought of tapping into the camera network.”

“What?”

“To learn! To study how people do it.” Her cheeks flush. “I, well I haven’t exactly had sex with a living person. You see, there weren’t a lot of young people my age in Dryl when I was a teenager. Most of the citizens left after the first Rebellion. Anyway, there was one boy. I was twelve. We kissed, but then he didn’t want to do it again. I figured out a lot later it was probably because I told him we needed to do it ten more times, to test different positions. When I was fourteen, there was a girl. But she said I was too weird.” She looks away from him, towards a blank wall. “After that, I did a ton of research - every book, manual, video, anything I could get my hands on. Then I made some special robots. I programmed them and experimented with them. I also, well, experimented on myself.” She wiggles her gloved fingers. “You know.”

Hordak’s jaw drops, ever so slightly. She hasn’t done the couplings with anyone else. He will be her first mate. He is completely unsurprised by the robots - of course that is what'd she do. But…

the touching, too? Do all Etherians do this? Maybe there is something in the atmosphere.

He must ask. “Is this… normal for Etherians?”

“Well, the sex-bot part, no. That took a lot of time to get right, too. But the touching part? That’s normal. Well, the books said it was.”

Hordak exhales slowly, relief washing over him. He is not an abomination after all.

Entrapta smirks. “For me, I needed to know what to program the bots to do. But I assume most people do it to learn what they like, so they can tell their partners. Otherwise it'd be trial and error. That's not so much fun for the other person. You know, if you mess up. Or vice versa.”

This makes sense. Also, the partners communicate with each other. Hordak did see that in the video footage, but didn't quite put it all together. He will not have to guess at how to please Entrapta. She will tell him. And, likewise, he should tell her.

The relief disappears, replaced by the cold, familiar feeling of failure. He cannot tell her what he does not know.

“You're doing that angry perfectionist thing again,” she tells him. “Your ears are back against your head and you’re scowling.”

He tries to speak, chokes, and clears his throat. Trying again, the words stumbling over his tongue, he mutters, “I will not be able to communicate… what I like.”

“Well of course not! How could you? You don’t know!”

A new type of warmth blooms in his chest. “This is… acceptable to you?”

“Well, I thought about it a lot last night while I was watching you sleep. You’re a clone. You missed a lot of things that I, and

everyone else, experienced as part of growing up. You just woke up one day as an adult. You were never a child, or more importantly, a teenager."

She leaves the terminal to sit down on his resting platform. She pushes down on it and wriggles her bottom a bit. "Oooh, very soft. Very nice. Anyway," she pats a spot next to her, "come sit if you want. Or stay where you are. That's kind of the point. You get to choose - for everything sexual we do together. I decided that'll be easiest. You just do, or don't do, whatever you want. I'll follow your lead, until we're both comfortable with… well, whatever." Her feet don't quite touch the floor, and her legs are swinging slowly as she speaks. "I will offer up suggestions, though. There are so many things I want to try! But if something doesn't feel right, you need to tell me 'no'." She grins. "I don't think that'll be a problem. You're big on 'No'."

This is unexpected. The other couples he viewed just followed the pattern. Kissing, touching, mouths on genitals, penetration. What Entrapta is proposing is far less structured, and if he's honest, a lot less intimidating.

"Since you aren't coming over here, you must be comfortable over there. That's fine. But this will go a lot easier if you tell me what you're thinking."

She is correct. Communication is required. "It is unexpected – what you describe. I assumed it would be as the others are." Hordak points to the terminal.

"If you saw something you liked, we can certainly try it!" Her eyes narrow and her grin turns sly. "You can even show me."

"You just want to view the footage."

"Of course I do! We could study it together."

"It's actually rather repetitive. They begin with the lip-pressing, then they put their mouths on each other's bodies, then the

genitals, then penetration. Even the female-only and male-only pairings – it's all very much the same…"

Entrapta's eyes pop open. "How many people did you watch? You saw same-sex couples?"

"Many. And yes. Plus one coupling of two females and a male. But the male was abusing his position of authority." Imp uncovered a very dark and sordid behavior pattern with that human. Beast Island was almost too kind a sentence for him.

She frowns, hair ruffling. "If you won't let me watch them from here, I'll just hack into the network myself."

He knows she will. "I will consider it. Since you requested that I communicate what I am thinking – I need you to build a device to remove my armor, so I may clean my body."

"Oh, you don't need a device. My bad. I forgot to show you." She hops off his resting platform and presses along the sides of the crystal on his chest. He feels the armor release along his arms and torso, the cables disconnecting from his ports with minimal pain. "You should be able to remove the arm pieces like sleeves, and pull the chest plate over your head."

He tests this, removing the sleeves, finding it quite effortless. The armor is somehow lighter than before. But when he lifts the chest plate, his strength dips and the heavy metal clatters to the floor as he drops to one knee, grunting at the influx of pain.

Entrapta is at his side at an instant, her hair supporting him as he struggles to stand. "I was afraid of that. I was hoping the crystal would heal your body as well. Maybe it hasn't been on long enough." She helps him over to his resting platform, where he sits and stares at the floor as the pain diminishes.

It is fragile then, his strength. He should have realized this, but he felt so like his old self that he was blind to reality.

Her hair touches his bare shoulder. “Give it time. You are far too impatient. Science, and healing, take time.”

He growls in reply. She’s right, and perhaps there is hope. “I am grateful for what you’ve done. It is…” He looks up, and she is standing before him, her eyes dark and focused on the space between his legs.

“I really do want to see what you look like.” Her voice is a husky purr.

“You have already seen most of it.”

“Not all of it.”

The glimmer of an idea crosses his mind. “You may see me, after I’ve seen you.”

His plan backfires. “That’s fair,” she states. She removes her boots and overalls without a hint of reservation. Then her mask, gloves and protective sleeves join the pile on his floor. She’s clothed only in a strapless top and a pair of white panties.

It’s then she hesitates, but only for a moment. Hordak just stares, his organ throbbing and getting larger by the second as she peels off her top and then her panties.

“Well,” she shrugs, “this is me.”

The majority of her skin is golden, except for the rosy patches on her chest. The fur between her thighs matches her hair, and is thick, short, and curled. Mesmerized, he reaches for her, tracing a claw along the curve of one breast.

She flinches but steps closer to him, standing between his legs. “So... umm... now what?"

Hordak’s brain overloads, flooded by a raw and primal urge. He *wants* her. No, it is a need, debasing and savage, and he surrenders to it.

"This," he growls, grabbing her waist and pulling her to him, pressing his mouth against her skin, right above her navel. She yelps in surprise, but Hordak ignores her. She is cool, soft and slightly salty. He moves his mouth upwards and Entrapta gasps in his ear when his lips touch her raised nipple. He saw males suckle this spot on the females, so he does the same. She reacts with a groan and rests her forehead against his neck. Her hair is stroking his arms and his back, her hands gripping his shoulders.

He leans back and guides her onto his resting platform, and with an unexpected burst of strength, he rolls her onto her back until he's straddled atop her. Her eyes have that glassy look again. Hordak takes this as a positive sign. He trails kisses down her neck, amazed by how natural this feels. It isn't difficult at all.

He suckles again, this time on the other breast, and she responds with a groan. He spends a bit of time there before traveling his mouth down her body to the patch covering her opening. His heart is pounding in his chest, and his organ is as tight and burning as it has ever been. He quickly adjusts it within his undergarment so that it is not as painful.

He looks at her, and their eyes meet. He's wanted to do this to her since he saw it weeks ago, but is unsure if this will please her.

Entrapta whimpers, nodding before he can find the words to ask her permission. "Just… teeth and claws will hurt."

Hordak huffs. "I would never harm you."

He spreads her thighs and very gently, and with utmost care, traces his fingertips along her inner thigh. Her skin trembles beneath his touch and with his thumb, he parts the curls and gently strokes her open. She looks like the diagram in the manuals, the skin is a richer, darker hue than the rest of her. His thumb moves slowly, up and down against what was described as the most sensitive part of a female. This causes her to spread her legs wider, and she sighs heavily.

“It’s so different…”

He leans down to touch her with his lips, but stops when her hair lifts her body, raising her until she is eye level with him. Ah. That will help. He sits back onto his legs and grasps her bottom to bring her close, until her thighs are resting on his shoulders. When his tongue touches her, she twitches in his palms. He waits and then licks her, gently. She tastes slightly sour and salty, but it is not unpleasant. He continues and she begins to moan, a continuous, wavering echo.

He tries to mimic the movements of the female/female couplings. They were the most skilled with this act. He presses his tongue against her, dipping it into her opening and then stroking lightly upwards. She gasps and squeaks, “oh yes, that!” He grins. She is making this very easy for him. He presses his tongue deeper into her, repeatedly sliding it against that spot. Her body wriggles in his hands so he tightens his grip and holds her there, probing and stroking.

She groans. “Please... don’t stop.”

Hordak does stop, but only to look up at her. Entrapta’s eyes are closed, her cheeks flushed a deep pink, her hair tightly clenching each side of his resting platform. He never viewed her as beautiful, beauty isn’t something he prioritizes. But he is beginning to understand it now.

“As you wish,” he growls.

Then he plunges his tongue back into her and proceeds to kiss, lick and suckle her with abandon. His chest is overflowing with warmth and an unfamiliar, but pleasing, lightness. Her moans cease, only to be replaced by a choppy whimpering breathing. Hordak has heard this before, and the other females who made these noises experienced great pleasure shortly thereafter. His tongue strokes her, light and fast, and it is not long before her bottom tightens in his hands, her back arching as she cries out, a gasping, guttural wail. He can feel her opening contracting against

his lips, and he marvels at that. He didn't know females did that – but he is glad there is a physical sign of successfully pleasing her.

He lowers her as her body relaxes in his grip. He feels very powerful, and very masculine, as he does what that first male did, and wipes the fluids from his mouth. His organ is throbbing, but he's ignoring it. He's given Entrapta pleasure. Pride is an understatement.

She is still, eyes closed, chest heaving. It's the longest she's ever been silent in his presence. He caresses the top of her brow before rising from the bed. She will need a cloth. He's seen that many times.

Hordak slowly enters his washroom, and splashes cold water from the sink against his face, using some to rinse out his mouth. He is weak without his armor, but not debilitated. Maybe that tech is healing him. He returns with a small towel, placing it beside Entrapta's hand, which is slowly releasing its grip on the coverings. Her hair is limp, splattered across the platform and dangling over the sides. She's also mumbling to herself.

"… focus… didn't… must've learned… chemistry?"

She inhales deeply and exhales slowly. "That was… surprising." She grins. "And really, really good."

His chest blooms with warmth and pride.

She looks up, and his state of arousal, although not as significant as before, is obvious against his tunic.

"Now it's your turn."

Chapter 5

Chapter Summary

A/N: *points at rating with some insistence*

Timeline: After S3E2 (Huntara) but before Season 3, Episode 4 (Moment of Truth)

Hordak swallows hard. Entrapta is eyeing him like a predator stalking its prey. He steps backward, his stomach fluttering. He's not ready for this. Pleasing her is one thing – that was easy and quite enjoyable. He is eager to do it again. But experiencing it himself, something so foreign to his kind? That's another issue entirely.

"You're nervous. Don't be nervous," she tells him, propping herself up against his pillow while pulling his sheet over her shoulders. "That's better. I was getting cold. You need to think of the science. It's an experiment."

Hordak says nothing. Because anything contrary to her statements would be a lie.

"I promise, it won't hurt."

She can't possibly know what this will be like for him. He is not Etherian.

"Although," she mutters, "if you really don't want to, that's okay. I did say I wouldn't pressure you. Despite, you know, this..." she waves her arms, "being all *your* idea." She stares him down, an odd smirk painted across her face. "I didn't think you were the type to renege on your commitments. That doesn't seem very, well... you."

"It is not," he snarls.

Her tone is distinctly mocking. "Are you sure?"

He growls, but then pauses. “You are attempting to provoke me.”

“Is it working? Are you going to take your clothes off now? That was our deal. I take off mine, you take off yours.” She grins. "It's only fair."

Hordak sighs. It is just clothing. He can remove it, honor their agreement, and don it again. “Fine.” Petulant, he unclasps the securing belt around his waist before lifting the back part of his tunic over his head and letting the whole thing fall to the floor. Her eyes widen at the sight of him in his undergarment, his organ still slightly swollen against the damp fabric.

“That too,” she murmurs, pointing at it.

His face aflame, he peels off the undergarment and steps out of the pile on the floor. “There,” he snaps.

She makes a circling motion with one tendril of her hair. “Turn around.”

He has never felt so exposed, or foolish, in his life. But he does as he’s told. “Does this satisfy you?”

He turns back to face her, and is startled to find her hovering directly in front of him, her weight again balanced by her hair. His sheet is draped across her shoulders, each half wrapped around her arms, leaving the rest of her body exposed. Unlike him, Entrapta shows no discomfort with her nudity. “It does,” she purrs.

She is studying him rather intently, and Hordak wonders if she will touch him as he did her. Then he wonders if he wants her to, and he cannot decide.

“I’ll wait,” she says quietly. “It’s your choice.”

How can she read him so well? “It… I… clones are not meant to experience pleasure, Entrapta. We are not designed for it.”

“Based on what I’m seeing, you are absolutely designed for it.”

He cannot deny that. His body behaves as if mating is something it can do. “It goes against Prime’s teachings.”

She nods. “I get it. This would be the first time you’ve disobeyed him?”

Hordak ponders that. It would not. The fact he has a name is already in violation of Horde Prime’s directives. Many of the things he’s done within the Fright Zone are actually bending the will of Prime. Everything he’s done with Entrapta to date, including his research with the videos, is absolutely a violation of Prime’s wishes.

“It seems not.”

“Then it’s up to you. What do *you* want, Hordak?”

He blinks. Her question sends his mind reeling. He is Hordak; he knows what he wants. The portal. Returning to Horde Prime. Proving he is worth something to the one being in the universe whose opinion matters. But... now there’s Entrapta. She also matters, and she accepts him as he is. She believes he is worthy of being her friend. Her partner. Her mate.

He knows exactly what he wants. “I want it *all*.”

“Okay, so does that include sex, or…?”

He grabs her shoulders and yanks her to him, the contact with her flesh sending a jolt throughout his body. “It does. Touch me. Bring me pleasure.” Entrapta's eyes grow wide with shock, and Hordak babbles as he quickly releases her. “If you want. I mean… when you are ready… I didn’t…”

A tendril of her hair touches his lips, quieting him. She grins, and with a soft laugh says, “I’m going to take all that as a hard ‘Yes’. Is that right?”

Hordak nods, gulping down the fear bubbling in his throat. He doesn't know what will happen, but he wants this.

"Finally!" Entrapta begins to examine him in earnest, her hair and fingers wandering over his body. He can tell she's cataloguing every little detail about him, and he lets her. It is strange, but not unpleasant.

"C'mere," she says, stepping backwards, guiding him with her hair. "Sit on the bed."

He does as she asks, and she moves behind him, her body pressed against his back. Her hair is caressing his legs, stopping at his boots. Should he remove them?

"They can stay," she says softly. "It's your ears. Whenever you are debating something, they twitch and turn inward."

So that's how she's doing it. He jumps when he feels her lips upon his neck.

"You didn't like that?" she asks. Her words are hushed, husky. Heavy with an emotion Hordak can't identify.

"It surprised me. I cannot see you."

"Noted." Her hair lifts her until she's in front of him, hovering over his lap. She lowers herself onto his legs and he balks. Her skin is now warmer than his, and he begins to understand why she is fascinated by heat. But her opening is extremely close to his swollen organ.

"We cannot."

"We're not."

"Then what are you…"

She kisses him into silence and his thoughts grow foggy. There is only her, and her touch, and a strong need to touch her in return.

He gives into it, cupping her face in his hands. She breaks away and smiles, her hair gently placing his palms on her chest.

When her lips kiss his neck, his organ starts to throb in time with his rapid heartbeat. She's creating a tingling sensation he hasn't felt before, and the soft moans she's making while he strokes her breasts with his thumbs are stirring something deep within him.

He gasps when she touches him, lightly caressing the skin near his tip. There's an ache that continues to grow as she moves her fingers up and down his shaft, testing him, squeezing gently. He grunts when her grip tightens, his eyes closing as he drowns in the new sensations. Moments later, her fingers stop and her weight lifts from his lap. Then her hair is spreading his legs apart.

"Just for a little bit," she murmurs.

And then there is nothing but heat, tension, and softness. It is surrounding his organ and it feels exquisite. By the heavens, this is better than he could have ever imagined. There is a pull, a stroking he recognizes as her tongue. He moans as the ache rapidly turns to need. There is an instinct to move, to thrust, and his body trembles as he fights the urge to slam into her mouth. "Entrapta…"

The heat of her lips leaves him and is replaced by a different type of pressure. Her hand moves, slowly at first but when it increases in speed, he knows what she is doing and is helpless to stop her. His hips shift in time to her movements and his world is shrinking to nothing but the pleasure sensations of friction, combined with that growing, burning, unidentifiable need.

Then there is a liquid warmth stroking back and forth across the base of his exposed tip. This, along with the tightness of her hand, makes the sensations double, then triple. There is a hollow, raspy breathing that must be coming from him. The warmth disappears, only to return moments later, moving faster, pressing harder. His eyes are squeezed shut, the need blazing within him so fiercely he is certain he will die from it. Then she does

something else, something light and fast that feels incredible. He gasps at the intensity until a hard spike of indescribable pleasure streaks bright across his mind and explodes into every nerve ending within his body. He groans loudly, his organ pulsing and his testicles twitching, that aching need finally fulfilled.

“Fascinating,” Entrapta’s voice is distant and hollow in his still-ringing ears. “That answers that question. I’d call this experiment a success.”

Hordak tries to open his eyes, but fails. His breathing is labored, his mouth open. Was he panting? His claws are buried deep into the padding of his resting platform, the covering punctured by them. His heart continues to beat staccato within his chest, unwilling to slow down. He raises his head, blinking to clear his vision.

Entrapta is kneeling on the floor, wrapped in his sheet, beaming up at him. “So, how was it? You ejaculate, by the way. Seems exactly the same as what all other mammals do." Her tone is tinged with disappointment. "No glowing or different colors.”

“Ehhrr…” He cannot form coherent words. His brain is swirling, dizzy from what he just experienced.

“I’ll take that as a positive. I’ll have to update my notes later. It was my first time doing that.” She chuckles softly. “Come here.” She wraps him within the sheet, pulling him close before pushing him down onto the resting platform and snuggling in next to him. “I did study it pretty extensively though. I have some ideas for improvement, now that I know how you work.”

He doesn’t care. She can do whatever she likes. He sighs in contentment as his body stretches out alongside hers. He feels no pain, no weakness, just a fuzzy sense of comfort in every cell of his body. This is not what he expected. She feels nice curled up next to him, and her hair is wrapped around them both, trapping body heat under the sheet like a cozy little cocoon. His thoughts

are wispy, laden with echoes of the pleasure sensations, until they fade to nothing at all.

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Hordak wakes to a dim room, and no Entrapta. How long did he sleep? He rises, noticing he is clothed and coated in his armor. He checks, and he has a new undergarment on. How she managed to accomplish all this without waking him is beyond him.

He scans his room, but there is nothing to indicate where she has gone. However, there is a small pile of linens and multiple towels piled near his doorway. She changed the coverings? Puzzled, he heads to his door when he hears rattling from overhead.

"Hordak! You're awake! Great. We need to talk." Entrapta drops down from the ceiling carrying a bundle within her arms.

Seeing her fully dressed again has a unique effect on him. His mind is recalling her nudity, and when her clothing moves and shifts, he is picturing the curves of naked flesh underneath. He shakes his head to clear it.

"Not coherent yet, huh? That's okay. I brought you food. It'll help. I don't think you eat enough. I didn't make it this time – Emily was insistent I get nutrient packets and MREs from the cantina." Her hair extracts a wrapped bar from the bundle and shoves it in his face. "Here. Take this."

Hordak grimaces and swats it away.

"Just like the soup," she grumbles. "You need to eat."

"I do not."

"You do. You may not like it, but your organic body needs fuel. And hydration. I think part of your problem is that you aren't taking care of yourself."

He scoffs. He takes great care with his body.

“When’s the last time you ate? Or drank?”

Hordak ponders that. “Yesterday. Before testing the portal.”

“See? That’s almost thirty-six hours ago.” A tendril of her hair pokes him harshly. “You may not need food the way the rest of us do, but you still need it. And liquids – whatever your alien physiology needs for hydration.”

Thirty-six hours? Has it really been that long?

“Perhaps you are right.” He takes the bar from her and starts munching on it. It is not appealing, but eating in this manner never was. Clones are given all the nutrients they need when they return to their resting pods. They are powered down, the waste removed, and new nutrients provided via their ports. This happens once a day, based on an intricate schedule that allows for a resting pod to be re-used by multiple clones. It is highly efficient, extremely sanitary, and very orderly.

Hordak recalls the first time he had to eliminate waste on his own and shudders.

“That’s better,” she states. “Don’t forget the liquids. I had issues with remembering to eat when I lived back in Dryl. I just got so busy. So I had people who made the food for me, and I had bots that would bring it to me. They made the best tiny food and fizzy drinks!” She sighs. “I miss that. But you run this place. You could have something like that set up here.”

Hordak likes that idea. Food and drink could be provided to the Sanctum for both of them, allowing them even more time to repair the portal, which is now the primary topic on his mind. He heads over to his terminal and launches the program to create a work order. He will even request that her meals be ‘tiny’.

This is going well. The majority of his problems are now solved. He has his new armor, and his body’s unwavering need to mate with Entrapta should no longer be an issue. It is sated - Hordak can feel the physical sense of satisfaction. Nothing remains to

distract him from their work on the portal. He might even increase his attacks against the Rebellion in his spare time.

Entrapta must be psychic, because she says, "We should also talk about the portal. I've sent some bots to clear the wreckage, but it will take us a couple of days to repair it. And we still need to figure out what's missing before we try again." Her hair touches his shoulder. "Don't be impatient. We'll get there."

He growls in reply.

"In the meantime, we can work on your armor, and letting your organic body heal."

He turns away from the terminal to face her. She's standing very close to him, raised to eye level by her hair, and his brain instantly clouds over. Her scent is powerful, feminine, and uniquely her. He remembers drowning in it when he was probing her with his tongue. And her eyes are rather pleasant to look at, aren't they? His hand is on her face before he even thinks to touch her, and she leans into his palm with a sigh.

He strokes her cheek with his thumb before pressing his lips against hers. She kisses him back but then hastily retreats, pointing at the pile near his door. "I need to drop those off at the laundry before they lock the door for the evening. While I'm there I'll see if I can get quite a few more of, well, everything. I suspect we're going to need them."

Hordak's chest is filled with that light feeling again. She is caring for him. For them. "I… appreciate your efforts."

She straightens. "It's what partners do for each other. At least, I think it's what they do. Oh! Almost forgot the most important thing. I went to one of the medical bays and... we're protected now. It was not a pleasant experience. Not at all. But I told myself it's for science! And, well… other things." She fidgets with her glove. "So, maybe give me a day or two, and then if you want, we can conduct some more… serious experiments."

His organ swells quickly, and Hordak is forced to admit his earlier assumption was false. His body is not sated. Far from it. He wonders if it ever will be. He smiles as he watches Entrapta disappear into the ductwork. There really is only one way to find that out.

Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

A/N: *cough* *cough* ***RATING*** *cough* *cough*

Timeline: After S3E2 (Huntara) but before Season 3, Episode 4 (Moment of Truth)

Hordak grins as he finishes a weld on the piping in front of him. Testing his new theory, he glances over at Entrapta. As expected, their eyes meet. Hers flash in embarrassment before she quickly looks down at the snarl of cables in front of her. He can't quite suppress his smirk as he returns his attention to the power inlet. This makes ten. Ten times he's caught her staring at him.

They've been repairing sections of the portal the entire morning; it is indeed in shambles. But Hordak doubts she's made any significant progress. He hasn't either; he is far more interested in watching her as she watches him.

There have been many times he couldn't keep his eyes from her. But now, the situation is reversed. Why is she acting this way? He is quite confident he gave her pleasure yesterday. Perhaps her body has a shorter half-life in terms of that insatiable need? His has dimmed to a simmer, still there, just not as distracting. At least, as long as she is not nearby. If she is close to him, Hordak knows his body will respond. Thinking about her is already causing stirrings within his organ.

Still, she clearly stated she needed a day or two before they could interact again. Whatever she implemented to prevent procreation apparently takes time to be effective. He can wait that long, but perhaps she cannot?

Hordak shakes his head. That logic is weak. She's never watched him like this before, and per her own words, she's wanted to mate

with him as well. Something else is on her mind, and he is curious about it.

He returns to his micro-welding, counting backward from one hundred. This will be an interesting day. The dynamics of their situation have finally shifted into his favor. When Hordak's countdown reaches zero, he peers up at her. Their eyes meet, again. Entrapta's hair frizzles and she mutters something to her bot before dragging it and herself out of his line of sight. He chuckles softly. Yes, this is an interesting day.

Entrapta departs for her quarters early that evening, but Hordak stays late in a halfhearted attempt at productivity. The early evening moon is high in the night sky when he finally leaves his Sanctum. As he enters his quarters, he wonders if she is inside, waiting for him. There is a pang in his chest when he discovers she is not. However, when he enters his washroom, he discovers a large pile of the smaller towels, folded neatly on a once-empty shelf. He checks his closet, and three separate sets of sheets and coverings are there.

She was here, just not at the same time he was. Uncertainty flitters through him. Why wouldn’t she stay?

The next day Entrapta is unusually distant, and Hordak realizes she is actively avoiding him. He is familiar with the pattern, having done it himself many times. When their midday meal arrives, she barely touches it. Instead, he sees her picking at the tips of her gloves and muttering to herself before disappearing up into the ventilation tunnels, as she is wont to do when she needs a tool from her lab. But he does not hear the normal bang and thump of her passage. Surprisingly, she returns five minutes later and picks up her work as if nothing abnormal has occurred.

Then it hits him, the insight blindingly obvious. She is nervous!

His chest swells with warmth for her. He is nervous as well, but logically, any concerns about their future couplings are unfounded. They have already proven they can please each other. There’s no

reason the actual act of mating would be any different. Late last night, Hordak rewatched a couple of the more detailed performances on the surveillance footage, just to clarify a few things in his mind. He's fairly confident he can please her, and is certain she can please him. Every male he's ever watched is pleasured by this act. Some more rapidly than others, much to the dismay of the female partner. That is his primary concern. He does not want to receive pleasure whereas she does not.

"Entrapta," he murmurs, approaching her. "Is everything all right?" It's rhetorical. He knows it is not.

"Oh! Yes. It's fine. I've reconnected the wiring for the top section of the portal, and I reinsulated it. We should be able to mount it tomorrow. Although I really should re-check on the clamps at the ends - let me go do that now…" Her hair reaches for the ceiling, lifting her up and away from him.

Hordak wraps his hand around her arm and gently, but firmly, pulls her down before she can escape. "Entrapta."

She slumps, her hair retracting its claw-like grip from the pipes above her. Her gloved fingers pick at each other, and she will not meet his gaze.

"You are nervous," he says gently. "Why?"

"I'm not… oh, I guess it's obvious. Emily said you'd notice."

"I recall you stating that I needed to communicate what I was thinking. I am now requesting the same of you."

"I… well, I haven't done it with someone else before. And you were really good with what you did, like you knew what you were doing. It's probably because you've seen what it's like first… well, second-hand." She sighs. "I haven't – well, not really. Not with normal people. What I've seen is… never mind. And I still haven't hacked into the surveillance network yet. I'll get it, but it's taking longer than I thought. They have a rolling three second access

code based on a double-encrypted random number generator. And that's just the authentication layer."

Hordak makes a mental note to recognize that balding security officer. Perhaps a promotion. This is his work, and Hordak is grateful for it.

She mumbles, eyes to the floor. "I just don't want your first time to be bad."

He scoffs. "I am certain it will not be."

"How can you know? Maybe I'm bad at it. I'm bad at a lot of things."

Hordak growls low. "Do not discredit yourself." He pauses. "You said it was my choice of when and what we did with our couplings. It is also yours. If you are not comfortable, I will wait."

Entrapta grabs his arms and shakes him. "But… I really want to! There are so many things I want to know!" She immediately releases him and shrinks into herself. "I just… don't want to mess it up."

He brushes her cheek with the back of his hand. "You will not." He doesn't know how else to reassure her. "I do not wish to see you distressed. The decision is yours. There is no urgency." A voice in his head screams negative at that. There is absolutely an urgency. He must crush her to him and kiss her until she pants and gasps. He must penetrate her, to mark her as his own, over and over again. Hordak's imagination slams into overdrive, picturing her naked and writhing beneath him, just like those females in the videos, and his undergarments grow tight.

"Oh." She looks crestfallen.

His fingers touch her chin, lifting her eyes to his. "Entrapta."

She meets his gaze, and he grins slyly at her. He deliberately looks down at the now-apparent bulge in his tunic. She does the same.

“Oh! I… oh.”

“I will be ready when you are.”

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Entrapta comes to him late that night. Hordak suspected she would and planned accordingly. However, there is a different air about her. It’s in the way she carries herself, the pace of her breathing. Whatever uncertainties she had earlier are now gone. In their place is something else, something he’s seen glimpses of but didn’t fully understand. Entrapta is no ordinary Etherian. She is a Princess. Hordak never viewed her as such, as those other Princesses are flighty and incredibly annoying. But he cannot deny what he sees. There is a power emanating from her, deeply feminine and highly intoxicating.

She is silent as she stands next to his resting platform, peeling her clothing from her body with a casual grace before pushing it off to the side with her hair. She is bathed in the dim moonlight as she approaches him, highlights and shadows making her appear almost ethereal. Her eyes burn a deep rose, almost to red.

He meets her halfway, clothed only in his tunic. “I will get you access to my door,” he murmurs, wiping a smudge of dust from her cheek.

“Okay.”

Hordak undresses in front of her, surprisingly unafraid. She reaches for him, running her fingertips down his chest, feather-light. “I’m ready for this. Are you?”

He remains still as her hands wander over him, his pulse racing. They are going to do this. He is going to mate with Entrapta. His body is responding as expected, his need for her quite obvious. He hopes she sees it, as she is the cause of it. She is the cause of all of this, and he doesn’t regret one instant of it.

Her hair travels down his sides, his legs, and back up to his abdomen, hovering near his organ. It twitches – anticipating her touch. But she doesn't touch him.

Instead, her eyes bore into him. She is waiting for his answer, but there is something else burning in that fiery crimson gaze. Something that is compelling him to surrender himself to her.

Time halts, until she murmurs, “You need to say it.”

He yields. “Touch me.”

His organ throbs as tendrils of hair begin to stroke his shaft and his tip. He reaches for her, pressing her naked flesh against his. Their lips meet, igniting a hunger between them. It hovers at the fringe of his mind, a new sensation. Their tongues touch, briefly, and then again with more intensity until they separate, and he trails his mouth against her collarbone, nipping her gently.

Her moan is soft, the vibration tangible against his lips. His hands cup her breasts, thumbs stroking, palms squeezing. Her hands are grasping at his shoulders, and her hair has not stopped caressing him.

He guides her to his resting platform, and she lays on her back, her hair releasing him to spread wild around her.

He crawls over her, his upper body straddling her legs. Entrapta’s eyes darken and her thighs shift apart. But if he must yield, then so must she.

“Say it,” he growls.

Her response shoots fire into his very core. “Please.”

Hordak spreads her wider and buries his head in her fur. Her scent is irresistable, heady and erotic. He parts her with his tongue and then plunges it deep within her. She is wet, hot and soft. He licks and strokes, until her breathing turns harsh and jagged. Hordak lifts his head, waiting for her direction. Her chest is rising and

falling, and the combination of need and uncertainty he sees in her burn an ache in his chest so strong, he fears his heart might melt from it.

She nods. “If you want to.”

He grabs himself and attempts to align his organ with her opening. Entrapta's hand joins his, and she spreads herself wide and guides him while he pushes himself slowly forward.

The warmth of her body surrounding his tip is overwhelming, and he gasps. Her hair shoves his hips forward and he enters her fully. They both groan and Hordak’s mind nearly implodes from sensory overload.

This is nothing like her mouth. This is something else entirely, something unique and perfect. There is pleasure everywhere. He presses forward, his body balanced over hers, his arms bearing his weight. Her body responds, pressing back against his. He retreats and slides into her again, and she meets him. Instinct takes over and he moves within her, retreating and entering over and over.

It’s ecstasy. This, what they are doing, is the pinnacle of that word. It is fast becoming the pinnacle of everything within his entire existence. Hordak’s mind pinpoints to nothing but her, but them. Prime, the Fright Zone, his army, the portal - none live in his consciousness. It is only Entrapta, the friction, and the heat of her body surrounding his.

There is an urge to push deeper, but he is concerned he might hurt her. She is so much smaller than he is. Hordak glances down at her, curious. She’s watching him, heavy-lidded and slightly breathless. She smiles up at him, raising her knees and spreading her legs wider. He thrusts, and she moans. He thrusts harder, and she moans louder. “Yes. Like that.”

He complies, forcing his body to slow as he plunges into her. Males who moved slowly had longer sessions of coupling. The

ache has long progressed into need, a persistent nagging in his mind begging him to pound himself into her until she screams. But he fights it and follows her rhythm, each stroke more pleasurable than the last. He tilts his hips upward, and feels her body shift, allowing him to enter her just a little bit further.

She makes a noise, half-cough, half-whine. Hordak grinds hard against her and she repeats it. He starts to thrust again, his pace quickening, his resolve weakening. A growl escapes his lips as his choppy breathing progresses to panting.

Entrapta is panting as well, her body curving toward his. Her hair wraps itself around them, tendrils clinging to his arms, his legs, his back. She whimpers and the tendrils tighten. The spikes of almost-pain overwhelm him, shattering his last wisps of control. He snarls, a feral sound originating deep within his throat, as he finally succumbs to his baser instincts and buries himself inside her. He slams against her, again and again, grunting as the sensations override his rational mind. There is only one thought now: she will be his and his alone.

Her whimpers turn to cries as her head tilts back and her body arches off the platform, her hair digging into his skin. The heat and tension inside her grows, her soft yelps increasing in frequency until her body bucks hard against him and she howls his name. That sound, combined with a slight pull and fluttering deep within her, drive Hordak's need to its breaking point. He gasps, whimpering as if in pain, as a white-hot bolt of intense pleasure sears through every inch of his mind and body.

He braces himself over her, head hanging low, his breathing ragged. His claws are bunched in the coverings, and he's lost all perception of time and space. He has no idea how long he's poised there until dimly, he begins to worry about Entrapta.

Hordak blinks to clear his vision. Entrapta is sweaty and spent beneath him, eyes closed, mouth open as she steadies her breathing. She is so small, so fragile. And her hair is… everywhere.

Words are difficult to form, but with great focus he's able to ask, "Are you all right?"

She does not respond.

Fear prickles his mind. "Entrapta?"

"Mmmm… yes? that was… yes."

Relief floods him. His loss of control, what he did to her… but she does not appear harmed. His heartbeat is still pulsing through his organ, now sated and shrinking inside her. He can feel it doing so. Hordak eases out of her as gently as he can, and the shock of cool air returns his brain to a semblance of normal.

There are milky white fluids, on him, on her, and on the coverings. So that's what they look like. He moves to lay next to her on his side, still concerned for her welfare. Her breathing has steadied, but she isn't moving. He traces a fingertip lightly down her arm, and her entire body shivers.

"Yikes! Sensitive!" Entrapta struggles to right herself. "Whoa. Dizzy. Wow." She stares at him. "You… we… that was…" She exhales slowly before grinning at him. "I definitely missed a few things when I programmed my sex-bots."

"Are you certain I did not harm you?"

"You didn't hurt me. At least, not in a bad way. It's been a while, so I might be a little sore later."

He frowns, but she places her hand atop his. "No, it's okay. That was… intense. In an incredibly amazing way." She blinks and her mouth opens in a half-gasp. "Um… maybe I should be asking you that question?"

Hordak looks at his arms, and there are deep indentations where her hair dug into his skin. Many of them.

Entrapta leans forward and peers around his waist to his back. “You don’t feel that?”

“My skin is thicker than yours.” She is still frowning. “Entrapta, I am not in pain.”

“Huh. I need to make some notes. This is a lot to take in – way more than I anticipated.” She glances down. “Maybe after I clean up a bit.”

Hordak reaches behind him to the towels he left under the platform. “Here.”

She studies him. “You’re a fast learner, aren’t you?”

He shrugs. It isn’t something he’s considered before.

“What about you?” She gestures with the towel.

“I will need to bathe.”

“That probably isn’t a bad idea for me either. Where’s your shower? I didn’t see it in the bathroom.”

“My bathing needs are different than yours.”

“Oh?” Her eyes are wide with curiosity.

“My ports are not completely waterproof. A chemical coating removes unwanted bacteria from my body. It is then rinsed off and I am dried by blowers.”

She hops off his resting platform, wrapping herself in the crumpled sheet dangling off the side. “So that’s what that cabinet is for! Tell me everything!”

He walks with her toward his bathing stall, explaining how he and Shadow Weaver created it, and through a little trial-and-error, how he learned how long to wait for the chemicals to take effect. It’s not until they are in front of it that he realizes he is still naked.

“Interesting." She waves her hand. "Okay – go ahead.”

Hordak scowls. This process is not something she needs to see.

Entrapta scowls back. She’s wrapped in his sheet with her arms folded across her chest. He isn’t going to win this battle. “Fine.” He steps in, presses the appropriate buttons, gets sprayed, and waits, feeling for all the world like a creature on display for others’ amusement. Entrapta watches him for a few moments before disappearing, returning clothed once more and carrying his clothing and armor as well.

The requisite five minutes pass, and the buzzer chimes. Hordak flinches when he is doused with the ice-cold water, and then the blowers activate. He runs the blower cycle again and steps out. There. Done.

He hates this.

Entrapta sniffs his skin as her hair hands him his boots, armor, tunic and a clean undergarment. “What exactly is this?”

Hordak dresses himself while replying, “A highly diluted mixture of sodium hypochlorite, sodium hydroxide and sodium lauryl ether sulfate.” He inhales when the First Ones’ crystal is against his chest, its power once again flooding through his system.

She scoffs. “That’s what I thought. Bleach. She’s bleaching you. I guess that works. Does it hurt or burn? I saw you flinch.”

“No. The water is very strong, and extremely cold.”

“What?” Entrapta sticks her head inside the stall. “Is there a reason it has to be cold?”

“It has always been cold.”

“Hordak, you do know there is hot water in the Fright Zone, right?”

He blinks.

“Are the blowers warm?”

“No.”

“They will be.”

Her hair is fluffed. She is angry. “Okay, so I know we didn’t do the post-coital cuddling thing, but since you don’t have a shower, and there are multiple reasons why I should probably take one, which I won’t share with you because you really don’t need to know, it’s best I head back to my room. Plus now I need to research the Fright Zone’s plumbing system.” She mutters to herself, and Hordak catches the word ‘sadistic’ as well as an Etherian curse word. Entrapta's hair lifts her until she’s nose-to-nose with him. A thick strand separates, patting him on the top of his head. “Don’t worry. I’ll get you fixed up.”

Her hair pulls her up to his ceiling and she disappears into the ventilation shaft.

Hordak watches her leave, bemused. There is hot water in the Fright Zone?

Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

A/N: There is no rating warning for this chapter. *headdesk*

Timeline: *STILL* after S3E2 (Huntara) but before Season 3, Episode 4 (Moment of Truth)

Entrapta is hovering over his terminal when Hordak enters his Sanctum. "Hordak! Finally. I need you to approve these work orders." Her hair carries her to him, and she shoves a data pad into his chest. "The reason there is no hot water in your shower is because there is no hot water plumbed to your room. There's no hot water in this entire zone. So I came up with a better idea. A couple, actually." Her head tilts. "Why did you want that room anyway? It isn't even designed as sleeping quarters. This all used to be some type of repair facility."

"When my ship crashed in the Fright Zone, the king was hospitable to me. I requested a private space to isolate me from the citizens while I attempted to salvage my ship, and that is the room he gave me." Hordak shrugs. "It suited me at the time, and once he surrendered to me, I made the remainder of the building into my original Sanctum. Over the years, I expanded it to what it is now."

"Why did you do it?"

"I needed the space." Why else would he expand the Sanctum?

"No, not that." Her pretty features morph into sadness. "Why did you take over the Fright Zone? And attack the other kingdoms?" Her eyes shift to the floor. "And hurt people."

"I had to. This world's leaders, particularly that king and queen of Bright Moon, would not listen to reason. They would not surrender themselves to my rule. This is what the Horde does, Entrapta. Throughout the galaxies, we conquer worlds in the

name of our Emperor. We bring peace and harmony to the universe. It is the will of Horde Prime. Your backwater planet is not the first I've conquered." He growls, a familiar self-loathing simmering in his chest. "It is, however, the first I've had to conquer entirely on my own." It's been decades, and he still has not succeeded. He needs that portal. Prime's armies will crush the Rebellion in hours.

"Interesting." She peers up at him. "Are there a lot of you? Clones, I mean."

"There are thousands of clones. Perhaps tens of thousands if you count those that are stationed on the various planets under Horde Prime's control. All have various skillsets. I was honored by Prime to receive specialized training in military tactics. I committed myself to the role, moving up in rank until I earned my place by his side."

"Which is when he discovered your defect." She scowls. "I don't understand that. If he is so technologically advanced, why wouldn't he just, well, repair you?"

"Clones must never be defective. Any deviation from the perfection of Horde Prime is an abomination. It was his will that my last service to him be to serve on his front lines. To die for his vision."

Entrapta's hair ripples. "And you agreed?"

"I did not have a choice," he replies. "A clone's purpose is to serve Horde Prime. What I am doing here, this war with the Rebellion, it is all in His name." The words are jarring to his psyche. That is an untruth. A lot of what he's done on Etheria, especially recently, has not been in service of Prime. It's been in service to himself.

Her words draw him away from his traitorous thoughts. "But you didn't die. A portal brought your ship here."

"Correct."

“And somehow you convinced hundreds of Etherians to join you. To fight against the oligarchy of the ruling classes and their Princesses.”

“It was not difficult. There is always a segment of a world’s population that is unhappy with the status quo. Fuel that fire, and you have allies for your cause. I found the unwanted, the oppressed, and the abandoned. I took them in. Fed them. Clothed them. Housed and trained them.” In the beginning, his fledgling army was fueled by a passion of hatred so strong, there was little he needed to do to guide them. They were already itching for battle. He just provided them with military-grade weapons and tidbits of technology to help them succeed.

“Each year,” Hordak continues, “my soldiers conscripted other Etherians to grow the Horde’s power and aid the cause.” He thinks of the librarian. “Some came willingly. Others, less so. But I do not treat my people unfairly. Those who prove themselves worthy are rewarded.” Hordak recalls his promise to recognize that security officer. Truly, he should be appointed Head of Security. If the position does not exist, Hordak will create it. He can join the senior leadership council as well.

“But you raise children to be soldiers,” she counters. “Is that fair?”

“Would you prefer I leave them to scavenge the streets? To perish in the Whispering Woods? Or the Wastes? I do not snatch children from their families, Entrapta. Most of the younglings were abandoned long before my soldiers found them. Some were causing havoc within their respective villages. They have a place here.”

“Interesting.” Her tone is neutral – her lack of emotion disconcerting.

Hordak’s brow furrows. Has she changed her mind about him? “Is there a reason for your questioning?”

“I guess I wanted to understand your point of view. My entire life I’ve heard stories about you. How ruthless you were, how evil. I didn’t pay a lot of attention to it. I had better things to do – like researching the First Ones and their fascinating tech! Speaking of which, we’d better get back to repairing the portal so we can start figuring out the right combination of First One’s tech to open it.” She scuttles over to her section of the portal, her bot waddling out of the shadows to join her. “Don’t forget to submit those work orders,” she says before flipping her mask down and lighting her blowtorch. Her words are muffled, but Hordak thinks she says, “We’ve got more experiments to conduct.”

The conversation leaves him unsettled. If he didn’t know her one-track mind so well, he’d think she changed the subject deliberately.

They work late into the evening, and Hordak’s chest fills with warmth as he watches Entrapta yawn. It was a good day; they made significant progress with the portal’s repairs. One section is completely restored, and the remaining sections should be operational soon. He could not have done this without her, and to say he is grateful is an understatement.

He’s spent the past couple of hours debating ways to convince her to return to his quarters with him. His mind has been fantasizing about pleasuring her, his body reacting accordingly. He takes a deep breath and exhales slowly. The simplest ways are always the best. He will just ask her.

But his feet will not move, and that annoying fluttering has returned to his abdomen. This is lunacy. The worst that will happen is she says ‘no’. The instant the thought enters his mind, a familiar pain streaks across his chest. Rejection. He is unworthy. It is surprising in its intensity.

Has she become that important? He studies her, and finds the statement is truth. Their conversation from earlier in the day

resurfaces. Her opinion matters to him. Greatly.

Hordak scowls, the abrasive brush of logic painting an unpleasant picture. There is a downside to the couplings. He saw this repeatedly on the footage, but dismissed it. Now he is paying the price for his folly. Mating creates an attachment, one driven not by reason, but by emotion. By giving into his baser instincts, by allowing the cravings of his body to overrule the rationality of his mind, he has activated those emotions within himself.

Clones do not express emotion. It is an honor reserved only for Prime. But as he learned the moment he landed on Etheria, clones are quite capable of producing emotions. Fear. Loneliness. Anger. Despair. In the beginning, they overwhelmed him. But eventually he learned to control them. Over the years, more developed. Pride. Disgust. Sadness. Even happiness. Each he tamed into submission. They do not rule him. But now, due to his interactions with Entrapta, new ones are forming. Softer ones. And, he admits, a few rather lewd ones. They are not yet under his control. It's distressing, and somewhat humiliating.

His thoughts are disrupted when he sees Entrapta slump over onto the table in front of her. He hurries to her, finding her asleep. She's overworked herself to exhaustion. He thinks back on the past few days, and doubts she's even slept at all. He smirks. Who is the one not taking care of themselves now?

Her bot and Imp are crowding around her, the latter standing near her head and studying her with great concern. The tiny creature chirps softly, tugging at her hair.

"I see you have fallen for her too," Hordak murmurs. "Do not worry. She just needs to rest." Imp squeaks, widened eyes gaping at him while the bot beeps in surprise. "You cannot see she is exhausted?" he retorts. Then he realizes what he said, and heat spreads across his cheeks.

He ignores the two as he lifts her easily. It seems he will not have to ask her to join him in his quarters tonight. However, the

pleasuring will have to wait. Her hair curls around his shoulders and she snuggles against his chest with a soft sigh. She remains that way until he disentangles her hair from his body and settles her onto his resting platform, pulling his sheets and covering over her body. He retrieves another covering from the closet; she's indicated many times that she gets cold in this space.

As he spreads it over her, his chest burns with that strange light feeling. The bot and Imp have followed him into his quarters, and they are observing him as he tends to Entrapta. Imp is sitting atop the bot, grinning wide.

"Yes, you miniature heathen," he mutters, his voice just above a whisper. "I care for her."

"<I care for her,>" Imp echoes. "<Fallen for her.>"

"Repeat it again at your peril. The same applies to you, bot." It twitters nervously, stepping backward, away from him and Entrapta. The movement forces Imp to fly up to one of the thin pipes below the ventilation shafts.

"Calm yourself. I will not harm you. You may stay here for the evening, as long as you are silent." The bot beeps, and Hordak raises a brow. The bot makes no further noise, but scurries to one corner and settles itself onto its legs.

He points at Imp. "You may not. Out."

His tiny companion cackles and departs through the open doorway. Hordak sighs, his brain weary. He locks his door and joins Entrapta on his resting platform, careful not to disrupt her as he lifts the sheets and coverings. This is not how he planned this evening, and he is not comfortable with his latest realization regarding his emotional state. He should not have any emotions at all, let alone enough to qualify as an actual state.

Her arms wrap around him as she pulls herself close. She murmurs, "Warm. Nice. Sleep now."

Hordak sighs again, reaching over to brush a few rogue wisps of her hair from her face. The warm, light feelings in his chest are overwhelming. “Yes, little Princess. Sleep.”

^*^*^*^*^

Hordak wakes to a knocking on his door. Entrapta is still fast asleep, her body turned away from him, her hair limp along her back. Hesitant to disrupt her, he eases out of his resting platform and pads quietly to the door.

When he opens it, two roughshod humans are standing outside, one tapping on the security panel. Their eyes widen in fright. “Lord Hordak!” the one sputters. “We… ah… didn’t know you were inside. We are… uh… here to continue work on the water heater.”

The other waves his data pad. “They’re labeled ‘Urgent’.”

Hordak is torn. He does not want these two humans to see Entrapta. However, he does not wish to delay the repairs of his bathing chamber, either. “Wait here,” he commands before shutting the door.

Sadly, he’s going to have to wake her. He is poised over her, but hesitates. She is so peaceful, a slight half-grin tinting her lips. His expression mirrors hers as his chest warms. The portal repairs can wait. There is no harm in taking a day for relaxation. And perhaps, as she puts it, experimentation. He can survive one more cleaning, if needed.

He taps on the bot in the corner. “Watch over her. I will return shortly.”

He opens his door, stepping outside to speak with the humans. “You may continue your repairs tomorrow.” Reading their immediate and obvious looks of glee, he adds, “And bring with you the work orders you complete today, in lieu of my own. I expect the number to be significant. Do I make myself clear?”

Their frivolous ideas of their own day off fade from their faces. Both swallow hard and nod. “Yes, Lord Hordak.”

He strides forward, and the pair backpedal out of his way. Amused, he continues down the hall, his destination the Horde kitchen.

A frustrating hour later, Hordak returns to his quarters. His presence in the cooking and food preparation area caused an abject panic of the humans and other races working there. In viewing the state of the entire facility, Hordak could understand why. It was unabashedly cluttered, bordering on unsanitary. Unacceptable. When he returns tomorrow morning, he expects to see a completely reformed kitchen. If not, he will fulfill his promise to the manager he spoke with today. Threats of banishment should be enough to motivate them properly.

Still, it was not a complete waste of time. The kitchen staff now knows to deliver his requested version of their meal to his quarters, and not the Sanctum.

He quietly shuts his door. Entrapta has not moved, but the bot has positioned itself at the foot of his resting platform, its legs holding it high as it attempts to block the morning moonlight quickly spreading across her.

“You are wise, bot,” he whispers to it. He taps on his terminal and a panel slides down from the ceiling to cover the skylight. “We do not wish to wake her.” His quarters darken, the only light provided coming from the various tech panels within the ceiling and walls, and the bot itself.

Hordak settles himself at his terminal, his fingers quiet as he performs a search within the security roster. The security officer’s name is Hagan. He grins as he enters the data into the requisite forms, similar to those used for promotions to Force Captain. *Welcome to my senior staff, Chief Security Officer Hagan.*

A few hours later, Entrapta finally stirs, mumbling to herself as she stretches her body and her hair. Hordak knows all this because he's been happily watching her as he lies beside her.

"Whuzza…?" She blinks sleepily before turning to face him. "Oh! Hello. Why're you in my room?"

He can't suppress his mirth. "I am not. You are in mine."

She sits up. "Oh! Well. Kinda dark, isn't it?"

"I brought you here. You fell asleep in the Sanctum." He again swipes those stray tendrils from her face. "I suspect you have not slept much in the past few days."

"Well, that's not entirely my fault. You're the one who thinks it's okay to bathe in ice water. And before that… well, it's all been about you, hasn't it?"

He scoffs. "Perhaps from your point of view. To be fair, it's been about us. It seems we are not all that dissimilar in our behavior when it relates to items we deem important." He's had some time to think on this while she slept. Her dedication matches his own. It's one of the reasons they work so well together.

Hordak continues, "You stated that partners care for each other. So today, I will care for you. You may stay here with me and rest, or you may do whatever else you might wish. But you are forbidden from working on the portal." He taps her nose with his claw, reading her expression. "I am serious, oh stubborn one. My one suggestion is that you at least stay for the midday meal. It should be arriving shortly."

"So. Lemme get this straight. You're not working on the portal today."

"Correct."

"And neither am I." Her eyes grow wide. "And we're going to stay here, in your room, in your *bed*, for the entire day… and you've

got room service coming?”

“If you choose so, yes.” He assumes ‘room service’ is the meal arriving at his quarters.

She chirps in delight before squeezing him tightly. “What a great first date!”

He grins, returning her hug, but it is really an attempt to hide his puzzlement. He doesn’t know what a ‘date’ is. But if he made her happy, that is all that matters.

She lifts her head and kisses him. “This is going to be fun,” she purrs, her fingers tracing the edge of his ear. "Intimacy Experiment Number Three," she murmurs, reaching for his tunic. "Let's see what's different if you leave your exoskeleton *on*."

His organ throbs to life, and he swallows hard. May the fates grant him mercy. He gasps as the heat of Entrapta's mouth envelops him. And strength. And whatever else he needs to survive this day.

Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

A/N: Rating warning has returned! *points at rating, sadly for the last time*

Timeline: Starts one week before, and ends approximately one hour before, the beginning scene of Season 3, Episode 4 (Moment of Truth).

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Entrapta…"

She needs to stop. What she's doing with her tongue is exquisite but… they haven't discussed this topic yet. He's seen enough footage to know that some females do not mind, whereas others do mind. Significantly.

Hordak squirms, inching away from her. "Entrapta," he rasps, "you… uhhnngh…" He groans when her grip on him tightens. It takes every ounce of willpower he has to produce the words. "Stop. If you don't…"

Her lips release him. "Hmm…?"

"I…" he pants, "we haven't discussed… your preferences."

She peers up at him in confusion. "Preferences for what?"

His cheeks burn. "For what you are doing. For when I…" He can't bring himself to say it.

"Oh!" Her face flushes crimson, most likely matching his. "Well, that's part of this experiment."

"You are certain?"

“I’m willing to try.”

Hordak looks down at her, his entire being overflowing with an emotion he’s hesitant to name. He truly does care for her. And he knows her well enough to know of her sensitivities, and how she gets lost in the moment. “I… will not be able to stop it.” He could barely control himself a few moments ago. “You cannot change your mind.”

She huffs. “I know I haven’t seen what you’ve seen, but I do know what the expected outcome is here.” Her thumb glides over the opening of his foreskin. It’s light, and fast, and Hordak’s mind is clouding over. “So… you were close?”

“Yes,” he coughs. “Very.”

Her hand grips him, sliding the skin back and exposing him. She licks him lightly. “And now?”

“Not as much right… oh!” She has him in her mouth again. He can feel her laughter as she suckles.

Her tongue caresses him again before she murmurs. “I can fix that.” Her hair grasps his shoulders and waist, and shoves him hard against the wall behind his resting platform. “Stay. No more interrupting. I need to concentrate.”

A startlingly short time later, Hordak slumps over, his mind reeling as every cell in his body tingles within a thick, hazy afterglow. That... was unexpected. And astounding. The way the sensations spiked when he yielded to her...

Entrapta is on her stomach, looking up at him from between his thighs. Her hair releases him as she swipes at her mouth. “Wasn’t that terrible,” she mutters. “Whoever wrote that guide was exaggerating.” Her voice rises in pitch. “Did you feel anything different this time? Was it better? Seemed to last a little longer… at least until you interrupted me and I had to start over.”

“Uhhnnn…” When he is coherent again, he is going to request she withhold her questioning until his brain function has returned to normal.

“I’ll be right back,” she states, jumping off the platform. “Don’t go anywhere.”

He watches her hair carry her to his washroom. Where in the stars does she think he’s going to go? He can barely move. Being held down by her… it did something to him. Hordak doesn’t understand why it heightened his pleasure, but the intensity surpassed everything he’s experienced so far. And her hair was unbelievably strong, although he suspects leverage was a factor. He did test it; he did try to fight her. But he could not... This interaction between them is going to linger in his mind for quite some time. It isn’t possible for her hair to be stronger than the First One’s crystal.

Or is it? Hordak’s muted brain ponders that until he hears a clang from his washroom. What is she up to now?

He rises, still slightly dizzy. His tunic falls to cover him, and he hurries to the small doorway.

Entrapta is on her knees behind a large cylinder, her hair tightening the pipes around it. Hordak didn’t deem it necessary to review the work the plumbers had already completed, but they were obviously productive yesterday. In addition to the cylinder, there is an oval basin positioned on risers as well as a set of spigots and faucet jutting out from behind it. A single metal bar rises above the set, ending in a showerhead similar to the one in his bathing chamber. A metal ring is suspended from the ceiling, hovering approximately six feet from the top edge of the basin.

“What are you doing?”

“Getting this tub up and running,” she replies. “I don’t know why the plumbers didn’t finish the job.”

“I sent them away this morning. So you could rest.” He sighs, amused and frustrated at the same time. “This is not resting, Entrapta.”

“I know, but I can do this! I hooked up the wiring, the water is warming up now. I just need to connect these few pipes and… there!” She stands, her hair returning to her sides. “Let’s try it out.” She flips a lever on the cylinder, and then spins both spigots. Hordak can hear the rush of air through the pipes as water moves from the heater into the plumbing. Rusty brown liquid flows out the faucet, rushes into the tub, and then spills directly onto the floor.

She immediately shuts the spigots off. “Oops! No drain.”

Hordak massages his temple with his fingers. “Entrapta.”

Her hair grabs some of the towels and begins mopping up the spill. “Well, at least the heater is connected now.” She glances under the tub. “I could probably hook up the drain if I had the right parts.”

“Entrapta,” he repeats.

She starts digging through the box the plumbers left behind. “There should be a large piece and a couple smaller ones. Although it might need sealant too. I don’t know if there’s any sealant in here.”

Hordak opens his mouth to stop her, but then closes it. He has a better idea of how to break through her determined little mind. He walks to her and hovers over her. And waits.

“Are you going to help too?” She raises her eyes to him. “If not, you’re blocking my light again.”

Now that he has her attention, he kneels down to her level, and traces his fingertips across her cheek. “Entrapta,” he murmurs, cupping her face in his palm, “get up.”

She stands when he does, and Hordak strokes the hair along her brow. “No work today, remember?”

“But…”

He strokes her hair again, and her eyelids flutter. “No work,” he murmurs, his lips nearly brushing hers. He can feel her breath against his skin. “This,” he says, and then he kisses her.

She leans against him and he presses his lips against hers, then against her brow, and then back to her lips again. She kisses back with some intensity, but he doesn’t join her. Instead he steps away from her, and grabs her hand. “Come,” he says.

“Okay.”

Once they are back in his main living quarters, he turns and kisses her again, this time with more urgency. She stifles a squeak when his hands push her coveralls to her ankles. She kicks at her boots and wriggles out of the pile on the floor.

He guides her over to the table next to his terminal, lifting her onto it with ease. He returns to kissing her while his hands roam across her upper body and her thighs. Tendrils of her hair are already clinging to him, attempting to move his tunic.

He removes that temptation by tucking it into one of the cables on his side. If all goes well, it should remain there.

Hordak hooks his claws around the tight band of her undergarment. “It’s time for one of *my* experiments,” he says. “These are not a part of it.” She helps him remove it and he tosses it near the rest of her clothing.

She looks down at him, now erect and eager, and her hair starts to reach for him.

He swats at it. “No. You must not distract me. It is also my turn to... concentrate.” He growls the last word, stepping in close to her, shifting her thighs apart with his hips until she is open and

ready before him. He licks her neck, and she moans. He continues to nuzzle her while he positions himself against her. He can feel her heat and she is surprisingly wet.

Her hands and hair are still reaching for him, despite his statements requesting otherwise. So he slides into her, hard and fast. She gasps and he presses deeper, eliciting a soft cry as she shifts her hips to better align with his. Her hair is stroking him, and that needs to stop. He is not going to lose control this time. This time will be about her pleasure.

"I said no." Hordak grabs her hair directly above those two junction points atop her head. He wraps his hands around the tight clumps and slides them quickly downward, effectively capturing all of those wild tendrils within his fists. He pins her hair onto the table, his arms braced on either side of her. Then he begins to move, slowly. Gently.

She strains against him, but he does not meet her pace. She whimpers and he kisses her into silence, easing himself into her before retreating gradually. His teeth nibble at her neck and she moans. They move upward to her tiny ears and he feels her body twitch. Ah – a sensitive spot. He kisses her there.

"Hordak…"

He continues his leisurely pace, glad his body is still under his control, despite her continued requests for speed. She feels wonderful, but the overpowering urge to claim her is muted. He can only assume this is due to being satisfied a short time ago. He plans to make the most of the opportunity.

He returns to kissing her lips, teasing them open with his tongue. Hers is eager, intent, and he withdraws from her, moving downward to the other side of her neck, and then to the other ear.

"Hordak… please…"

Her hands are traveling down his chest, and he can't have those deft fingers doing anything to distract him. Her hair has been fighting him this entire time, and it wriggles in his grasp.

"Be still, Entrapta," he whispers.

"But…" she whines, her fingers brushing against his abdomen.

He nips at the soft skin behind her ear and she yelps.

"Be still," he growls, the command in his words unavoidable.

This has an immediate effect on her and her hair stops fighting him. Intrigued, he releases it, and it stays where he left it.

"Good," he purrs against her neck.

She moans and he increases his pace. He grabs her bottom and pulls her forward, forcing her onto her back. This improves how deeply he can enter her, and he plunges himself into her until her moaning switches to soft cries.

He matches her rhythm until she spreads her legs wide. Intrigued, he slows while tracing his fingertips along her abdomen. She shivers and he trails them along her skin until his thumb is barely touching that patch of lavender fur. He brushes against her, reaching lower with each caress. He's hunting for the right spot, and when she bucks against him, he knows he's found it.

He slams into her, once, twice and then freezes, letting his thumb take over, rubbing against that hard knub. Her hips arch into his palm and she groans loudly, her hands gripping the edge of the table. His organ throbs as her body contracts around him again and again.

Hordak waits, content to listen to the sound of her ragged breathing. When it stabilizes, he shifts his hips, rocking against her. She shudders but he continues, his hands holding her firmly.

"Now," he tells her, "we shall start my experiment."

“Wh-what?”

“I’ve pleasured you once, correct? We will now determine how many more times I can do it.”

Fifteen glorious minutes later, he has his answer. Three. He collapses against her, his mind buzzing and his body utterly drained. She is mute and immobile beneath him, hair limp and draping over the table. Hordak suspects this may have concluded their coupling sessions for the day. But he doesn’t regret it. Near the end she was quite vocal, her mewling cries of his name sending him over the edge. The Etherian curses were an interesting addition, though. He didn’t know Entrapta had that kind of vocabulary.

Leaving his armor on did not seem to produce any changes in his abilities to give, or receive, pleasure, but it does provide him with the strength to carry her back to his resting platform. He settles in next to her before draping the sheets and coverings over them.

“Hordak?” she murmurs.

“Yes?”

“That was a good experiment. But, no more for a bit, okay? I think you broke my brain. I can’t think straight.”

He laughs. “I am familiar with the sensation. It happens to me as well.”

“Really?”

“Yes. Every time.”

She snuggles up against him. “That’s good to know.”

“Why?”

“It just is.”

When their midday meal arrives, somewhat later than Hordak expected, Entrapta squeals in delight.

"Fizzy drinks! I didn't know they had them here!" She slurps on a straw. "Hey! It's good too! And this tiny food is *adorable*!" She pops a round, possibly smiling, blob of food into her mouth. "Still tastes like the Fright Zone, but it's cute so who cares?"

"I am glad you like it."

Entrapta pauses mid-bite. She swallows before saying, "You did this?"

"I requested it, yes." It's possible his request is what caused the delay. His people probably had to travel into one of the adjoining towns to get the necessary supplies. It's not like the Horde Army has a need for whatever a fizzy drink is, or for tiny food decorated like small, fluffy creatures.

She runs to him, wrapping her arms around him and squeezing him tightly. "Thank you!"

"I… uh… you are welcome."

She releases him, returning to the food cart. "Best date ever! Emily! Come here – I want you to see this."

After their meal, Entrapta disappears into the washroom. Hordak allows her a few minutes, but when she doesn't return, he joins her, shaking his head. She is incorrigible. This time the faucet is on, and water is collecting in a bucket within the basin. She shuts it off when he arrives.

"It's crude, but I was thinking we'd need to wash up after, you know, earlier. C'mere – the water is warm. The way it *should* be."

Hordak tests it with a claw. It is warm. It feels strange.

She hands him a small cloth and a square of Horde-issued soap. "The idea behind this tub was two-fold. First, it gives me a place to shower so I don't have to crawl through the ductwork back to my room. Second, it allows you to only wash certain parts of your body." She smirks. "You know. The important parts. I'll give you some privacy. Give it a try – let me know if it works for you. When you are done, just dump the water down the sink."

Bemused, Hordak watches her leave, the cloth dangling in his grip. His life certainly has changed these past few months. For the better, it seems. He wonders what he did to deserve such good fortune.

^*^*^*^*^

Hordak stirs sleepily. Entrapta is nestled under the crook of his arm, her hair wrapped around them. He studies her as she sleeps, her relaxed expression, her slow, even breathing. The past few days have been some of the best that he can recall within his lifetime. And he has lived a long lifetime.

Each morning begins exactly as this one has, with him waking next to her warm body tucked against his. They have an unspoken agreement regarding their schedule. The hours before the midday meal are dedicated to working on the portal. The hours afterward are up for interpretation, and a type of game has developed between them.

He has learned that subtle displays of dominance, as well as any contact with her face or ears, will have her yielding to whatever he proposes. He lacks originality though – as most of the time he just wants to pleasure her until she howls his name. He's contemplating some ideas, but the Etherian adage is holding true. What they do is definitely not damaged, and hence requires no repair.

She has learned that he cannot resist her scent, nor her own inherent power, and yesterday there was a long coupling session on the floor of his Sanctum, where she pinned him down and had

her way with him. The pleasure when he surrenders himself to her, it is indescribable.

They spend their evenings together in his quarters. It is a quieter, different time for them.

The remainder of their infamous “date day” was spent in his resting platform, with him answering her many questions. She does not lack for curiosity. His experience within the greater cosmos is, to quote her, fascinating. He never expected the knowledge he’d gathered through the years to be of value, but to her, it is all new and indeed, fascinating. He felt wise, and powerful, as he explained the different planets and galaxies to her. There is a specific galaxy he knows she’ll adore. It is amass with sentient robotic entities, although in those worlds they call them droids. There are thousands of different types, and Hordak knows she would adore them, especially the smaller ones.

Now, days later, the questions have subsided and she is content to be in his presence as he performs whatever administrative tasks he needs to complete on his terminal. She is welcome to use it for her own devices after his work is completed, and they had a short, but rather intense coupling two nights ago after she watched a few of his favorite clips from the surveillance footage.

Today they will finish the repairs on the portal. And eventually, she will find a way to make it work. Hordak hopes that day will not be soon. Because he has a new, and far more significant problem that he needs to solve. He must convince Horde Prime not only of his worth, but of hers. He does not want to live his life without her.

He grins, lightly stroking her hair. One day, he will show her the worlds beyond this one. It will be like paradise for her, and having her by his side will always be a paradise for him.

Chapter End Notes

TL;DR: Hordak has a problem. Hordak does some research. Hordak repeatedly thinks he's solved his problem, only to find he has not. Eventually his problem becomes such a big part of his life, he realizes it really wasn't a problem at all.

A/N: Welp, there you have it. THE END. If you made it this far - Thank You For Reading!

Endings like this are incredibly hard - I strongly prefer the HEA type. My apologies for the abruptness. Also, apologies for haphazard storyline - I might have skunked this fic. I am/was a little rusty and didn't know the ending when I started.

Sequels/Series -

If you liked this fic, guess what? It has two sequels! One is 'The Resiliency Trials', which is post-canon and assumes Hordak's memory was impacted by all that happened to him in Season 5. It is an epic redemption arc for Hordak (c'mon folks, he needs to be redeemed), as well as a massive fix-it fic. This is the official 2nd fic in this series and is a Mature-rated WIP.

The other is 'All The Frailties That Besiege', which is also post-canon and assumes Hordak's memory was not impacted by anything that happened in Season 5. It's a wild, crazy thing written from Entrapta's POV and is Explicitly Smutty (check the tags). It is complete, and a sequel to it is coming in Q1 2023 as part of the Entrapdak Positivity event happening around Valentine's Day.

Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!